

Rings and Modules

Labix

April 12, 2026

Contents

1 Basic Module Theory	4
1.1 Introduction to Modules	4
1.2 Module Homomorphisms	5
1.3 Isomorphism Theorem for Modules	6
1.4 Bimodules	8
2 Constructing New Modules	9
2.1 Direct Sum and Products of Modules	9
2.2 The Module of Homomorphisms	9
2.3 Tensor Products of Modules over General Rings	12
2.4 Tensor Product over Commutative Rings	13
2.5 Change of Base Ring	15
3 Generating Sets and Bases for a Module	16
3.1 Free Modules	16
3.2 Finitely Generated Modules	19
3.3 Invariant Basis Number Property	21
4 Exact Sequences of Modules	22
4.1 Introduction to Exact Sequences	22
4.2 Split Exact Sequences	25
5 Algebras over a Ring	28
5.1 Associative Algebras	28
5.2 Algebra Homomorphisms	28
5.3 Isomorphism Theorems for Algebra	29
5.4 New Algebras from Old	29
5.5 Free Algebras	30
5.6 Modules over Algebras	30
5.7 Algebras over a Group	30
5.8 Derivations of Algebras	31
5.9 The Enveloping Algebra	33
6 The Basic Building Blocks of a Module	34
6.1 Simple Modules	34
6.2 Semisimple Modules	35
6.3 Completely Reducible Modules	36
6.4 Maschke's Theorem	39
6.5 Cosimple Modules and the Radical	40
7 Special Ideals of a Ring	41
7.1 Nilpotent Ideals	41
7.2 The Annihilator of an Element	42
7.3 The Jacobson Radical	42
8 Chain Conditions	44
8.1 Noetherian Rings and Modules	44
8.2 Artinian Rings and Modules	46
8.3 The Length of Modules	48
8.4 Composition Series	48
9 Structure Theorem for Finitely Generated Modules over PIDs	50
9.1 Torsion of a Module	50
9.2 The Main Theorem	50
9.3 The Rational Canonical Form	51
10 Graded Structures	52
10.1 Graded Rings	52

10.2 Graded Modules	53
10.3 Homogeneity	53
10.4 Relevant Ideals	55
10.5 Graded Algebras	55
10.6 Noetherian Conditions	55
11 Tensor, Symmetric and Exterior Algebras	57
11.1 Tensor Algebra	57
11.2 Exterior Algebra	57
11.3 Symmetric Algebra	58

1 Basic Module Theory

1.1 Introduction to Modules

Definition 1.1.1 (Modules)

Let R be a ring. A left R -module or a left module over R is an abelian group $(M, +)$ together with an action of R on M denoted by $\cdot : R \times M \rightarrow M$ such that

- $r \cdot (m + n) = r \cdot m + r \cdot n$ for all $r, s \in R, m \in M$
- $(rs) \cdot m = r \cdot (s \cdot m)$ for all $r, s \in R, m \in M$
- $(r + s) \cdot m = r \cdot m + s \cdot m$ for all $r, s \in R, m \in M$
- $1 \cdot m = m$ for all $m \in M$ if $1 \in R$

A right R -module consists of the same axioms except that the action is on the right, meaning that the action of R on an abelian group M is the map $\cdot : M \times R \rightarrow M$.

Notice that while most of the time we exclusively work with left R -modules, all results are valid also to right R -modules because every right R -module is actually a left R^{op} module and vice versa. R^{op} here means that the abelian group is the same: $(R^{\text{op}}, +, \cdot_{R^{\text{op}}})$ is defined to be $(R^{\text{op}}, +) = (R, +)$ and

$$a \cdot_{R^{\text{op}}} b = b \cdot_R a$$

for all $a, b \in R$.

Example 1.1.2

The following are true.

- $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules are the same as abelian groups.
- $\mathbb{Z}$ -submodules are the same as subgroups.
- Let $\mathbb{F}$ be a field. Then $\mathbb{F}$ -modules are the same as vector spaces.

An abelian group can have different module structures. For example, the complex numbers $\mathbb{C}$ is both a $\mathbb{C}$ -module and an $\mathbb{R}$ -module.

Example 1.1.3

Let $\mathbb{F}$ be a field. Let V be a vector space over $\mathbb{F}$. Let $T : V \rightarrow V$ be a linear map. Then V can be given the structure of an $\mathbb{F}[x]$ -module structure by

$$\sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i \cdot v = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i T^i(v)$$

Definition 1.1.4 (Submodules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $N \subseteq M$ be a subset. We say that N is an R -submodule of M if N is an R -module.

Example 1.1.5

Let R be a ring. Then the following are true.

- The left R -submodules are the same as left ideals of R .
- The right R -submodules are the same as right ideals of R .

We have seen that left and right ideals of a ring in general do not coincide. More generally, left and right modules over a ring in general are completely different objects.

Example 1.1.6

Let $\mathbb{F}$ be a field. Let V be a vector space over $\mathbb{F}$. Let $T : V \rightarrow V$ be a linear map. Equip V with an $\mathbb{F}[x]$ -module structure by $x \cdot v = T(v)$. Let $W \subseteq V$ be a subset. Then W is a T -invariant subspace if and only if W is an $\mathbb{F}[x]$ -submodule of V .

Proposition 1.1.7 (Submodule Criterion)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. A subset N of M is a left R -submodule of M if and only if

- $x + y \in N$ for all $x, y \in N$
- $r \cdot x \in N$ for all $x \in N$ and $r \in R$

Proof Suppose that N is a left R -submodule. Then the above two conditions are satisfied since N is an R -module in its own right. Conversely, the above two conditions imply that the four conditions for the definition of a module is satisfied. ■

Lemma 1.1.8

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Then the intersection $M \cap N$ is a left R -submodule of both M and N .

Proof

Easy check using the submodule criterion. ■

Definition 1.1.9 (Sum of Submodules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $\{N_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of R -submodules. Define the sum of the submodules to be

$$\sum_{i \in I} N_i = \left\{ \sum_{j=1}^n n_j \mid n_j \in N_{i_j} \text{ for some } i_j \in I \right\}$$

Notice that the elements in the sum of submodules is a finite sum.

Lemma 1.1.10

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $\{N_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of R -submodules. Then $\sum_{i \in I} N_i$ is an R -submodule of M .

Proof

Trivial. ■

1.2 Module Homomorphisms

Definition 1.2.1 (R -Module Homomorphisms)

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be a function. We say that ϕ is an R -module homomorphism if the following are true.

- $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ is a homomorphism of the underlying abelian group
- $\phi(am) = a\phi(m)$ for $a \in R$ and $m \in M$

We say that ϕ is a R -module isomorphism if it is bijective.

Definition 1.2.2 (R -Module Isomorphisms)

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an R -module homomorphism. We say that ϕ is an isomorphism if there exists an R -module homomorphism $\psi : N \rightarrow M$ such that

$$\psi \circ \phi = \text{id}_M \quad \text{and} \quad \phi \circ \psi = \text{id}_N$$

Lemma 1.2.3

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an R -module homomorphism. Then ϕ is an isomorphism if and only if ϕ is bijective.

Proof

If ϕ is an isomorphism then clearly ϕ is bijective. Conversely, suppose that ϕ is bijective. We check that ϕ^{-1} is an R -module homomorphism. Let $n_1, n_2 \in N$ and $r_1, r_2 \in R$. Then there exists

$m_1, m_2 \in M$ such that $\phi(m_1) = n_1$ and $\phi(m_2) = n_2$ respectively. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}\phi^{-1}(r_1 n_1 + r_2 n_2) &= \phi^{-1}(r_1 \phi(m_1) + r_2 \phi(m_2)) \\ &= \phi^{-1}(\phi(r_1 m_1 + r_2 m_2)) \\ &= r_1 m_1 + r_2 m_2 \\ &= r_1 \phi^{-1}(n_1) + r_2 \phi^{-1}(n_2)\end{aligned}$$

Hence ϕ is an R -module homomorphism. ■

Definition 1.2.4 (The Kernel of a Homomorphism)

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an R -module homomorphism. Define the kernel of ϕ to be

$$\ker(\phi) = \{x \in M \mid \phi(x) = 0\}$$

Definition 1.2.5 (Quotient Module)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule of M . Define the quotient module of M and N to be the abelian quotient group

$$\frac{M}{N} = \{m + N \mid m \in M\}$$

together with the left ring operation $\cdot : R \times \frac{M}{N} \rightarrow \frac{M}{N}$ defined by

$$(r, m + N) = r \cdot (m + N) = rm + N$$

Example 1.2.6

Let k be a field. Then $\frac{k[x, y]}{(x^2 - y)}$ is both a $k[x, y]$ -module and a $\frac{k[x, y]}{(x^2 - y)}$ -module.

Lemma 1.2.7 Let R be a ring. Let I, J be left ideals of R . Then $\frac{R}{I} \cong \frac{R}{J}$ as R -modules if and only if $I = J$.

Proof When $I = J$ it is clear that $R/I \cong R/J$. Conversely, suppose that $\phi : R/I \rightarrow R/J$ is an R -module isomorphism. For any $r \in J$, we have

$$\phi(r + I) = (r + J)\phi(1 + I) = (r + J)(1 + J) = (r + J) = 0$$

Since ϕ is an isomorphism, we conclude that $r + I = I$, so that $r \in I$. This shows that $J \subseteq I$. Similarly one can show that $I \subseteq J$. ■

1.3 Isomorphism Theorem for Modules

Similar to the isomorphism theorem for rings, the isomorphism theorem for modules extends the definition of the original isomorphism for groups. Therefore most of the time we just have to check the compatibility of the isomorphism theorems with the ring action on the abelian group.

Theorem 1.3.1 (First isomorphism Theorem for Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an R -module homomorphism. Then the following are true.

- $\ker(\phi)$ is an R -submodule of M .
- $\text{im}(\phi)$ is an R -submodule of N .
- There is an isomorphism

$$M / \ker(\phi) \cong \text{im}(\phi)$$

given by the function $m + \ker(\phi) \mapsto \phi(m)$.

Proof

We have seen all these statements for groups. We just have to show that the statements are compatible with the left action of the left R -module structure.

- Let $r \in R$ and $m \in \ker(\phi)$. Then $\phi(r \cdot m) = r \cdot \phi(m) = 0$ and thus $r \cdot m \in \ker(\phi)$
- Let $r \in R$ and $n \in \text{im}(\phi)$. Then $r \cdot \phi(n) = \phi(r \cdot n)$ implies $r \cdot n$ lies in the image of ϕ
- Let $r \in R$ and $m + \ker(\phi) \in M/\ker(\phi)$. Denote the group isomorphism $\bar{\phi} : M/\ker(\phi) \rightarrow \text{im}(\phi)$ defined by $m + \ker(\phi) \mapsto \phi(m)$. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}\bar{\phi}(r \cdot (m + \ker(\phi))) &= \bar{\phi}(r \cdot m + \ker(\phi)) \\ &= \phi(r \cdot m) \\ &= r \cdot \phi(m)\end{aligned}$$

Thus they all are compatible with left multiplication. ■

Theorem 1.3.2 (Second isomorphism Theorem for Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $A, B \leq M$ be R -submodules of M . Then the following are true.

- A and B are R -submodules of $A + B$.
- $A \cap B$ are R -submodule of A and B .
- There is an isomorphism

$$\frac{A+B}{B} \cong \frac{A}{A \cap B}$$

given by the function $a + b + B \mapsto a + A \cap B$.

Proof

It is clear that A and B are subgroups of $A + B$. Moreover, the left R -action on A and B is closed since they are left R -submodules. Thus A and B are submodules of $A + B$. The proof for $A \cap B$ is similar.

Consider the composition of R -module homomorphisms $\phi : A \rightarrow A + B \rightarrow \frac{A+B}{B}$ defined by $a \mapsto a + B$. It is a homomorphism since it is the composition of the inclusion and the quotient map. This map is surjective since for any $(a + b) + B$, we have that $(a + b) + B = a + B$ and thus $a \in A$ maps to this element.

I claim that $\ker(\phi) = A \cap B$. If $a \in \ker(\phi)$ then $a + B = B$ implies that $a \in A$. Thus $a \in A \cap B$. If $a \in A \cap B$ then clearly $\phi(a) = a + B = B$. By the first isomorphism theorem, we have that

$$\frac{A+B}{B} \cong \frac{A}{A \cap B}$$

and we are done. ■

Theorem 1.3.3 (Third isomorphism Theorem for Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $A, B \leq M$ be R -submodules of M such that $B \leq A$. Then the following are true.

- A/B is an R -submodule of M/B .
- There is an isomorphism

$$\frac{M/B}{A/B} \cong \frac{M}{A}$$

given by the function $(m + B) + A/B \mapsto m + A$.

Theorem 1.3.4 (Correspondence Theorem for Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule of M . There is an inclusion preserving bijection

$$\left\{ K \subseteq M \mid \begin{array}{c} K \text{ is an } R\text{-submodule of } M \\ \text{containing } N \end{array} \right\} \xleftrightarrow{1:1} \left\{ K \subseteq M/N \mid \begin{array}{c} K \text{ is an } \\ R\text{-submodule of } M/N \end{array} \right\}$$

given by $K \mapsto K/N$.

1.4 Bimodules**Definition 1.4.1 (Bimodules)**

Let R, S be rings. An (R, S) -bimodule is an abelian group M together with the following data.

- M is a left R -module.
- M is a right S -module.
- For all $r \in R, s \in S$ and $m \in M$, we have

$$(r \cdot m) \cdot s = r \cdot (m \cdot s)$$

Example 1.4.2

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M be a left (right) R -module. Then M is an (R, R) -bimodule where the right (left) action of R is given by $m \cdot r = r \cdot m$.

Example 1.4.3

Let R be a ring. Let $n, m \in \mathbb{N}^+$. Then $M_{n \times m}(R)$ is an $(M_n(R), M_m(R))$ -bimodule.

2 Constructing New Modules

2.1 Direct Sum and Products of Modules

Definition 2.1.1 (Direct Product of Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let $\{M_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of left R -modules. Define the direct product of the collection to be the set

$$\prod_{i \in I} M_i = \left\{ (m_i)_{i \in I} \mid m_i \in M_i \right\}$$

together with the left R -module structure inherited component wise.

Definition 2.1.2 (External Direct Sum of Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let $\{M_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of left R -modules. Define the direct sum of the collection to be the set

$$\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i = \left\{ (m_i)_{i \in I} \in \prod_{i \in I} M_i \mid m_i \neq 0 \text{ for finitely many } i \right\}$$

together with the left R -module structure inherited component wise.

There is no difference between finite direct sum and finite direct products. However when I is an infinite indexing set, there is a big difference. For instance, a direct product of rings is still a ring but infinite direct product of rings is not a ring.

Proposition 2.1.3

Let R be a ring. Let $\{M_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of left R -modules. Then the inclusion homomorphism $i : \bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i \rightarrow \prod_{i \in I} M_i$ is an isomorphism

$$\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i \cong \prod_{i \in I} M_i$$

if and only if $|I| \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proof

Clearly if $|I|$ is finite then they are isomorphic. If the inclusion homomorphism is an isomorphism, then for any $(m_i)_{i \in I} \in \prod_{i \in I} M_i$ we have $(m_i)_{i \in I} \in \bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i$. If all of m_i are non-zero, then $m_i \neq 0$ for finitely many i implies that $|I|$ is finite. ■

Let R be a ring. Given a left R -module M , how can we recognize that M is isomorphic to a direct sum? We introduce the notion of internal direct sums to identify direct sums.

Definition 2.1.4 (Internal Direct Sum of Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $\{N_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of R -submodules of M . We say that $\sum_{i \in I} N_i$ is the internal direct sum of the collection if there is an isomorphism

$$\bigoplus_{i \in I} N_i \cong \sum_{i \in I} N_i$$

given by $(n_i)_{i \in I} \mapsto \sum_{i \in I} n_i$.

2.2 The Module of Homomorphisms

Definition 2.2.1 (The Set of Homomorphisms)

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Define the homomorphism ring of R to be the set

$$\text{Hom}_R(M, N) = \{ \phi : M \rightarrow N \mid \phi \text{ is an } R\text{-module homomorphism} \}$$

together with the following two binary operations:

- Let $\phi, \psi \in \text{Hom}_R(M, N)$. Define $\phi + \psi : M \rightarrow N$ by $(\phi + \psi)(m) = \phi(m) + \psi(m)$ for all $m \in M$
- Let $\phi \in \text{Hom}_R(M, N)$. Let $r \in Z(R)$. Define $r\phi : M \rightarrow N$ by $(r\phi)(m) = r \cdot \phi(m)$ for all $m \in M$.

Proposition 2.2.2

Let R be a ring. Let M, N be left R -modules. Then $\text{Hom}_R(M, N)$ is a $Z(R)$ -module.

Proof We first show that the addition operation gives the structure of a group.

- Since M is associative as an additive group, associativity follows
- Clearly the zero map $0 \in \text{Hom}_R(M, N)$ acts as the additive inverse since for any $\phi \in \text{Hom}_R(M, N)$, we have that $\phi(m) + 0 = 0 + \phi(m) = \phi(m)$ since 0 is the additive identity for M
- For every $\phi \in \text{Hom}_R(M, N)$, the map taking m to $-\phi(m)$ also lies in $\text{Hom}_R(M, N)$. Since $-\phi(m)$ is the inverse of $\phi(m)$ in M for each $m \in M$, we have that $-\phi$ is the inverse of ϕ

We now show that

- Let $r, s \in R$, we have that $((sr)\phi)(m) = (sr) \cdot \phi(m) = s \cdot (r \cdot \phi(m)) = s(r(\phi))(m)$ and hence we showed associativity.
- It is clear that $1_R \in R$ acts as the identity of the operation.

Thus we are done. ■

Example 2.2.3

Let $n, m \in \mathbb{N}^+$. Then we have

$$\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}} \left(\frac{\mathbb{Z}}{n\mathbb{Z}}, \frac{\mathbb{Z}}{m\mathbb{Z}} \right) \cong \frac{\mathbb{Z}}{\text{gcd}(m, n)\mathbb{Z}}$$

Proof Any $\mathbb{Z}$ -module homomorphism is determined by where 1 is mapped to. Let $\varphi_a : \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ be the $\mathbb{Z}$ -module homomorphism given by $[1] \mapsto [a]$. Then

$$[0] = [n] = n \cdot [1] \mapsto n \cdot [a]$$

implies that $[na] = [0]$. Hence m divides na . Let $km = na$ for some $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Then $a = \frac{km}{n}$. Now we know that $m/\text{gcd}(m, n)$ and $n/\text{gcd}(m, n)$ are coprime. For a to be an integer, k must lie in the set

$$\left\{ \frac{n}{\text{gcd}(m, n)}, 2\frac{n}{\text{gcd}(m, n)}, \dots, \text{gcd}(m, n)\frac{n}{\text{gcd}(m, n)} \right\}$$

and so the only possible choices for a are

$$\left\{ \frac{m}{\text{gcd}(m, n)}, 2\frac{m}{\text{gcd}(m, n)}, \dots, \text{gcd}(m, n)\frac{m}{\text{gcd}(m, n)} \right\}$$

and so $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}} \left(\frac{\mathbb{Z}}{n\mathbb{Z}}, \frac{\mathbb{Z}}{m\mathbb{Z}} \right) \cong \frac{\mathbb{Z}}{\text{gcd}(m, n)\mathbb{Z}}$. ■

Definition 2.2.4 (Endomorphisms of a Module)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. An endomorphism of M is a homomorphism $\phi : M \rightarrow M$. Denote the set of all R -endomorphisms by

$$\text{End}_R(M) = \{\phi : M \rightarrow M \mid \phi \text{ is a homomorphism of } M\}$$

together with two binary operations defined as follows:

- Let $\phi, \psi \in \text{End}_R(M)$. Define $\phi + \psi : M \rightarrow M$ by $m \mapsto \phi(m) + \psi(m)$.
- Let $\phi, \psi \in \text{End}_R(M)$. Define $\phi \cdot \psi \in \text{End}_R(M)$ by $m \mapsto \phi(\psi(m))$.

Proposition 2.2.5

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then $\text{End}_R(M)$ is a ring.

Proof

We first show that $\text{End}_R(M)$ is a group.

- Since M is associative as an additive group, associativity follows
- Clearly the zero map $0 \in \text{End}_R(M)$ acts as the additive inverse since for any $\phi \in \text{End}_R(M)$, we have that $\phi(m) + 0 = 0 + \phi(m) = \phi(m)$ since 0 is the additive identity for M
- For every $\phi \in \text{End}_R(M)$, the map taking m to $-\phi(m)$ also lies in $\text{End}_R(M)$. Since $-\phi(m)$ is the inverse of $\phi(m)$ in M , we have that $-\phi$ is the inverse of ϕ

We show the remaining axioms for a ring.

- Since composition of functions is associative, associativity follows
- The identity map id acts as the identity since composition of any map with identity is itself
- Since $\phi \in \text{End}_R(M)$ is a module homomorphism, we have

$$\phi((\psi + \varphi)(m)) = \phi(\psi(m) + \varphi(m)) = \phi(\psi(m)) + \phi(\varphi(m))$$

and thus distributivity is satisfied.

Thus we are done. ■

The following lemma shows that endomorphisms of R as an R -module consists of precisely the left multiplications of R by each element in R (Thus also having an isomorphism on right multiplication). Moreover, the ring structures are compatible so that it is not just a bijection.

Proposition 2.2.6

Let R be a ring. Then there is an R -module isomorphism

$$R \cong \text{End}_R(R)$$

given by $r \mapsto (x \mapsto r \cdot x)$.

Proof

We first check that the map $\phi : R \rightarrow \text{End}_R(R)$ is a ring homomorphism. For any $r, s \in R$ and $x \in R$, we have

$$\phi(r + s)(x) = x \cdot (r + s) = x \cdot r + x \cdot s = \phi(r)(x) + \phi(s)(x)$$

We also have $\phi(1)(x) = x = \text{id}_R(x)$. Finally, we have

$$\phi(rs) = x \cdot (rs) = (x \cdot r) \cdot s = \phi(s)(x \cdot r) = \phi(s)(\phi(r)(x))$$

It remains to show that ϕ is bijective. For injectivity: The kernel ϕ is 0 because letting $r \in \ker(\phi)$, we have $\phi(r) = 0$. But we also know that $\phi(r)(1_R) = 1_R \cdot r$. Equating gives $r = 0$. For surjectivity: Let $\eta \in \text{End}_R(R)$. Let $x \in R$. Then we have

$$\eta(x) = \eta(x \cdot 1_R) = x \cdot \eta(1_R) = \phi(\eta(1_R))(x)$$

Thus ϕ is a ring isomorphism. ■

Notice that in the proof it might be more natural to show first that $R^{\text{op}} \cong \text{End}_R(R)$ and then to show that $R^{\text{op}} \cong R$. The first isomorphism is naturally isomorphic but the second one is not. Naturality refers to category theory.

2.3 Tensor Products of Modules over General Rings

Definition 2.3.1 (Tensor Product of Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a right R -module. Let N be a left R -module. Define the tensor product of M and N to be the quotient abelian group

$$M \otimes_R N = \frac{M \times N}{\left\langle \begin{array}{l} (m_1, n) + (m_2, n) - (m_1 + m_2, n) \\ (m, n_1) + (m, n_2) - (m, n_1 + n_2) \\ (mr, n) - (m, rn) \end{array} \mid m, m_1, m_2 \in M, n, n_1, n_2 \in N, r \in R \right\rangle}$$

We write elements of the abelian group as $m \otimes n$ for $m \in M$ and $n \in N$.

The tensor product satisfies a particular universal property. For that we need to define the notion of R -balanced maps.

Definition 2.3.2 (R -Balanced Maps)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a right R -module. Let N be a left R -module. Let A be an abelian group. Let $\varphi : M \times N \rightarrow A$ be a function. We say that φ is an R -balanced map if the following are true.

- $\varphi(m_1 + m_2, n) = \varphi(m_1, n) + \varphi(m_2, n)$ for all $m_1, m_2 \in M$ and $n \in N$ and $r \in R$.
- $\varphi(m, n_1 + n_2) = \varphi(m, n_1) + \varphi(m, n_2)$ for all $m \in M$ and $n_1, n_2 \in N$ and $r \in R$.
- $\varphi(m \cdot r, n) = \varphi(m, r \cdot n)$ for all $m \in M$ and $n \in N$ and $r \in R$.

Proposition 2.3.3 (Universal Property of Tensor Products)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a right R -module. Let N be a left R -module. Then the tensor product $M \otimes_R N$ together with the quotient map $i : M \times N \rightarrow M \otimes_R N$ satisfies the following universal property: For any abelian group A and R -balanced map $\phi : M \times N \rightarrow A$, there exists a unique group homomorphism $\psi : M \otimes_R N \rightarrow A$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M \times N & \xrightarrow{i} & M \otimes_R N \\ & \searrow \phi & \downarrow \exists! \psi \\ & & A \end{array}$$

Moreover, $M \otimes_R N$ is the unique (up to unique isomorphism) abelian group with this property.

Proposition 2.3.4

Let R be a ring. Let M_1, M_2 be right R -modules. Let N_1, N_2 be left R -modules. Let $\varphi : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ and $\psi : N_1 \rightarrow N_2$ be R -modules homomorphisms. Then there is a unique group homomorphism $\varphi \otimes \psi : M_1 \otimes_R N_1 \rightarrow M_2 \otimes_R N_2$ such that

$$(\varphi \otimes \psi)(m \otimes n) = \varphi(m) \otimes \psi(n)$$

Proposition 2.3.5

Let R, S be rings. Let M be a right R -module. Let N be an (R, S) -bimodule. Let L be a left S -module. Then the following are true.

- There is a group isomorphism

$$(M \otimes_R N) \otimes_S L \cong M \otimes_R (N \otimes_S L)$$

given by $(m \otimes n) \otimes l \mapsto m \otimes (n \otimes l)$.

- Let T be a ring. If M is an (T, R) -bimodule or N is an (R, T) -bimodule, then the above isomorphism is a T -module isomorphism.

Proposition 2.3.6

Let R be a ring. Let $\{M_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of right R -modules. Let $\{N_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of left R -modules. Then the following are true.

- Let M be a right R -module. There is a group isomorphism

$$M \otimes_R \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} N_i \right) \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} (M \otimes_R N_i)$$

given by $m \otimes (n_i)_{i \in I} \mapsto (m \otimes n_i)_{i \in I}$.

- Let S be a ring. If M is an (S, R) -bimodule or all of N_i are (R, S) -bimodules, then the above isomorphism is an S -module isomorphism.
- Let N be a left R -module. There is a group isomorphism

$$\left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i \right) \otimes_R N \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} (M_i \otimes_R N)$$

given by $(m_i)_{i \in I} \otimes n \mapsto (m_i \otimes n)_{i \in I}$

- Let S be a ring. If N is an (R, S) -bimodule or all of M_i are (S, R) -bimodules, then the above isomorphism is an S -module isomorphism.

2.4 Tensor Product over Commutative Rings

The tensor product is in general an abelian group. It does not have a well defined R -module structure. However if the modules M and N have additional module structure, then we may equip the tensor product with module structures as well.

Proposition 2.4.1

Let R, S be rings. Let M be a right R -module. Let N be a left R -module. Then the following are true.

- If M is an (S, R) -bimodule, then $M \otimes_R N$ is a left S -module given by the left S -module structure of M .
- If N is an (R, S) -bimodule, then $M \otimes_R N$ is a right S -module given by the right S -module structure of N .

When we also consider the tensor product over a commutative ring with its module structure, one can also obtain a universal property for the tensor product (together with the module structure). For that we need to define bilinear maps, and the definition parallels that in Linear Algebra.

Definition 2.4.2 (Bilinear Maps)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M, N, L be R -modules. Let $\varphi : M \times N \rightarrow L$ be a function. We say that φ is R -bilinear if the following are true.

- $\varphi(r_1 m_1 + r_2 m_2, n) = r_1 \varphi(m_1, n) + r_2 \varphi(m_2, n)$ for all $m_1, m_2 \in M$ and $n \in N$ and $r \in R$.
- $\varphi(m, r_1 n_1 + r_2 n_2) = r_1 \varphi(m, n_1) + r_2 \varphi(m, n_2)$ for all $m \in M$ and $n_1, n_2 \in N$ and $r \in R$.

Proposition 2.4.3 (Universal Property of Tensor Products over Commutative Rings)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M, N be R -modules. Then the tensor product $M \otimes_R N$ together with the quotient map $i : M \times N \rightarrow M \otimes_R N$ satisfies the following universal property: For any R -module L and R -bilinear map $\phi : M \times N \rightarrow L$, there exists a unique R -module homomorphism $\psi : M \otimes_R N \rightarrow L$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M \times N & \xrightarrow{i} & M \otimes_R N \\ & \searrow \phi & \downarrow \exists! \psi \\ & & L \end{array}$$

Moreover, $M \otimes_R N$ is the unique (up to unique isomorphism) R -module with this property.

Example 2.4.4

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M, N be R -modules. Then $m \otimes 0 = 0 \otimes n = 0$ for all $m \in M$ and $n \in N$.

Example 2.4.5

Let $n, m \in \mathbb{N}^+$. Then we have

$$\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z} = \mathbb{Z}/\gcd(n, m)\mathbb{Z}$$

Proof

Define $\mathbb{Z}$ -module homomorphism $f : \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z} \otimes \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}/\gcd(m, n)\mathbb{Z}$ by $a \otimes b \mapsto ab \pmod{\gcd(m, n)}$. Clearly f is surjective since $1 \otimes 1 \mapsto 1$. We also show that f is injective. Suppose that ab is divisible by $\gcd(m, n)$. Then there exists $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $ab = \gcd(m, n)k$. Then $a \otimes b = ab(1 \otimes 1) = \gcd(m, n)k(1 \otimes 1)$. By Bezout's lemma, there exists $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$a \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} b = \gcd(m, n)k(1 \otimes 1) = (mx + ny)k(1 \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} 1) = xk(m \otimes 1) + yk(1 \otimes n) = 0 + 0 = 0$$

Hence f is injective. ■

Tensoring over different base rings can have unexpected consequences.

Example 2.4.6

We have $\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} = 0$.

Example 2.4.7

The following are true.

- $\mathbb{Q} \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{Q} \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}$ are isomorphic as $\mathbb{Q}$ -modules.
- $\mathbb{C} \otimes_{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{C}$ and $\mathbb{C} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}$ are not isomorphic $\mathbb{C}$ -modules.

Proposition 2.4.8

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M_1, M_2, N_1, N_2 be R -modules. Let $\varphi : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ and $\psi : N_1 \rightarrow N_2$ be R -module homomorphisms. Then there is a unique R -module homomorphism $\varphi \otimes \psi : M_1 \otimes_R N_1 \rightarrow M_2 \otimes_R N_2$ such that

$$(\varphi \otimes \psi)(m \otimes n) = \varphi(m) \otimes \psi(n)$$

Proposition 2.4.9

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M, N, L be R -modules. Then the following are true.

- Associativity: There is an R -module isomorphism

$$(M \otimes_R N) \otimes_R L \cong M \otimes_R (N \otimes_R L)$$

given by $(m \otimes n) \otimes l \mapsto m \otimes (n \otimes l)$.

- Commutativity: There is an R -module isomorphism

$$M \otimes_R N \rightarrow N \otimes_R M$$

given by $m \otimes n \mapsto n \otimes m$.

- Identity: There is an R -module isomorphism

$$M \otimes_R R \cong M$$

given by $(m, r) \mapsto rm$.

By commutativity of tensor product over commutative rings, we also have distributivity on the right. That is, there is an R -module isomorphism

$$M \otimes_R \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} N_i \right) \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} (M \otimes_R N_i)$$

for M and $\{N_i \mid i \in I\}$ R -modules.

Proposition 2.4.10

Let R be a commutative ring. Let $\{M_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of R -modules. Let N be an R -module. Then there is an R -module isomorphism

$$\left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} M_i \right) \otimes_R N \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} (M_i \otimes_R N)$$

given by $(m_i)_{i \in I} \otimes n \mapsto (m_i \otimes n)_{i \in I}$.

Proposition 2.4.11

Let R be a ring. Let I be an ideal of R . Then the following are true.

- Let M be an R -module. There is an R -module isomorphism

$$M \otimes_R \frac{R}{I} \cong \frac{M}{IM}$$

given by $m \otimes r + I \mapsto rm + IM$.

- Let J be an ideal of R . There is an R -module isomorphism

$$\frac{R}{I} \otimes_R \frac{R}{J} \cong \frac{R}{I+J}$$

given by $r_1 + I \otimes r_2 + J \mapsto r_1 r_2 + I + J$.

Example 2.4.12

Let $n \in \mathbb{N}^+$. Let A be an abelian group. Then we have

$$\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A \cong A/nA$$

2.5 Change of Base Ring

Definition 2.5.1 (Restriction of Scalars)

Let R, S be rings. Let M be an S -module. Let $\varphi : R \rightarrow S$ be a ring homomorphism. Define the restriction of M to R to be the R -module given by the abelian group

$$\text{Res}_R^S(M) = M$$

together with the module structure given by $r \cdot m = \varphi(r) \cdot m$ for all $r \in R$ and $m \in M$.

Definition 2.5.2 (Extension of Scalars)

Let R, S be rings. Let M be an R -module. Let $\varphi : R \rightarrow S$ be a ring homomorphism. Define the extension of M to S to be the S -module

$$\text{Ind}_R^S(M) = S \otimes_R M$$

Proposition 2.5.3

Let R, S be rings. Let M be an R -module. Let N be an S -module. Then there is an isomorphism of abelian groups

$$\text{Hom}_S(\text{Ind}_R^S(M), N) \cong \text{Hom}_R(M, \text{Res}_R^S(N))$$

given by $(f : \text{Ind}_R^S(M), N) \mapsto (f|_{1 \otimes R M})$.

3 Generating Sets and Bases for a Module

3.1 Free Modules

Free modules is the module analogue of vector spaces. There is an intrinsic and extrinsic way to defined free modules, but they both mean the same thing. The intrinsic definition is used to identify certain modules to be free.

Definition 3.1.1 (Free Module over a Basis)

Let R be a ring. Let B be a set. Let M be a left R -module. Let $i : B \rightarrow M$ be an injective function. We say that M is a free R -module over B if the following universal property is satisfied: For any R -module N and any function $f : B \rightarrow N$, there exists a unique R -module homomorphism $g : M \rightarrow N$ such that the following diagram is commutative:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} B & \xrightarrow{i} & M \\ & \searrow f & \downarrow \exists! g \\ & & N \end{array}$$

Lemma 3.1.2

Let R be a ring. Let B be a set. Then the following are true.

- The free R -module over B is unique (up to unique isomorphism).
- $\bigoplus_{b \in B} R$ is a free R -module over B .

Notice that $\prod_{i \in I} R$ is not a free module with I is not finite. Indeed, if the indexing set is not finite, the cartesian product is in general not isomorphic to the direct sum.

Example 3.1.3

Let R be a commutative ring. Then the following are true.

- $R[x]$ is a free R -module isomorphic to $\bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} R \cdot x^n$.
- $R[[x]]$ is not a free R -module but is isomorphic to $\prod_{n \in \mathbb{N}} Rx^n$.

Given an R -module M , how can we identify whether M is a free? We answer the question using the concept of a basis, similar to that in Linear Algebra.

Definition 3.1.4 (Basis of a Module)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $B \subseteq M$.

- We say that B is linearly independent if for every $\{b_1, \dots, b_n\} \subseteq B$ such that

$$\sum_{i=1}^n r_i b_i = 0_M$$

we have that $r_1 = \dots = r_n = 0_R$

- We say that B is a generating set of M if for all $m \in M$,

$$m = \sum_{b \in B} r_b \cdot b$$

for finitely many non zero r_b

- We say that B is a basis of M if B is both linearly independent and is a generating set of M .

By considering r_b being dependent on $b \in B$, we can define

$$\text{Fun}_f(B, R) = \{f : B \rightarrow R \mid f(b) = 0_R \text{ for all but finitely many } b \in B\}$$

then we can rewrite the definition of generating sets to be if for every $m \in M$, there exists $f \in \text{Fun}_f(B, R)$ such that $m = \sum_{b \in B} f(b) \cdot b$. We can also define linear independence in a similar fashion.

Basis for a module is similar to a basis for vector spaces. Indeed every field is a ring so one can think of modules as a generalization for vector spaces. However, not every module admits a basis like the theory of vector spaces.

Bases are closely related to freeness in the following way.

Proposition 3.1.5

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then M is free if and only if M admits a basis. In this case, M is the free R -module over the basis.

Another explanation for why $\prod_{i \in I} R$ is not free if I is not finite: Because in the definition of a generating set elements of the direct sum is a finite sum of elements. But elements in $\prod_{i \in I} R$ can have countably many long components.

Example 3.1.6 Consider the following abelian groups as $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules.

- $\mathbb{Q}$ is not a free $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.
- $\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$ is not a free $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.
- $\mathbb{R}$ is not a free $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.

The cardinality of two bases of a free R -module need not be equal.

Example 3.1.7

The following are true regarding the ring

$$R = \text{End}_{\mathbb{Z}} \left(\prod_{n \in \mathbb{N}^+} \mathbb{Z} \right)$$

- Let $\varphi_1 \in R$ be defined by $\varphi_1((a_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}^+}) = (a_{2n-1})_{n \in \mathbb{N}^+}$. Let $\varphi_2 \in R$ be defined by $\varphi_2((a_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}^+}) = (a_{2n})_{n \in \mathbb{N}^+}$. Then $\{\varphi_1, \varphi_2\}$ is a basis for R .
- $R \cong R^n$ for any $n \in \mathbb{N}^+$.

Proof

Define $\psi_1, \psi_2 \in R$ by

$$\psi_1((a_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}^+}) = (a_1, 0, a_2, 0, \dots) \quad \text{and} \quad \psi_2((a_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}^+}) = (0, a_1, 0, a_2, \dots)$$

Then clearly we have

$$\varphi_1 \circ \psi_1 = \text{id} = \varphi_2 \circ \psi_2 \quad \text{and} \quad \varphi_1 \circ \psi_2 = 0 = \varphi_2 \circ \psi_1 \quad \text{and} \quad \psi_1 \circ \varphi_1 + \psi_2 \circ \varphi_2 = \text{id}$$

Notice that for any $f \in R$, we have

$$f = f \circ \text{id} = f \circ (\psi_1 \circ \varphi_1 + \psi_2 \circ \varphi_2) = f \circ \psi_1 \circ \varphi_1 + f \circ \psi_2 \circ \varphi_2$$

Thus f is an R -linear combination of φ_1, φ_2 . Hence φ_1, φ_2 generate R . Now suppose that for some $f, g \in R$, we have $f \circ \varphi_1 + g \circ \varphi_2 = 0$. Precomposing with ψ_1 gives $f \circ \text{id} + 0 = 0$ Hence $f = 0$. Similarly precomposing with ψ_2 gives $g = 0$. Hence φ_1 and φ_2 are linearly independent. Hence $\{\varphi_1, \varphi_2\}$ forms a basis for R .

Define a function $h : R \rightarrow R^2$ by $h(f_1 \circ \varphi_1 + f_2 \circ \varphi_2) = (f_1, f_2)$. We first show that this is an R -module homomorphism. We have

$$\begin{aligned} h((f_1 \circ \varphi_1 + f_2 \circ \varphi_2) + (g_1 \circ \varphi_1 + g_2 \circ \varphi_2)) &= h((f_1 + g_1) \circ \varphi_1 + (f_2 + g_2) \circ \varphi_2) \\ &= (f_1 + g_1, f_2 + g_2) \\ &= (f_1, f_2) + (g_1, g_2) \\ &= h(f_1 \circ \varphi_1 + g_1 \circ \varphi_1) + h(f_2 \circ \varphi_2 + g_2 \circ \varphi_2) \end{aligned}$$

for any $f, g, r \in R$. Also we have

$$\begin{aligned} h(r \cdot (f \circ \varphi_1 + g \circ \varphi_2)) &= h(r \circ f \circ \varphi_1 + r \circ g \circ \varphi_2) \\ &= (r \circ f, r \circ g) \\ &= r \cdot (f, g) \\ &= r \cdot h(f \circ \varphi_1 + g \circ \varphi_2) \end{aligned}$$

Hence h is an R -module homomorphism. It remains to show that h is bijective. Suppose that $f \circ \varphi_1 + g \circ \varphi_2 \in \ker(h)$. Then $(f, g) = 0$ means that $f = 0$ and $g = 0$. Hence $f \circ \varphi_1 + g \circ \varphi_2 = 0 \cdot \varphi_1 + 0 \cdot \varphi_2 = 0$. Thus h is injective. Surjectivity is also clear by construction. Thus $R \cong R^2$. By induction, we conclude that $R \cong R^n$. ■

Because every ring R is a free R -module generated by the identity element, we see that two different bases of the above ring has different cardinality.

Lemma 3.1.8

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then M is isomorphic

$$M \cong \frac{\bigoplus_{i \in I} R}{J}$$

to a quotient of a free module for some left R -submodule J .

Proof Let M be an R -module. Choose a generating set $B \subseteq M$. This is always possible because trivially we can choose $B = M$. Define a map $\pi_B : \bigoplus_{b \in B} R \rightarrow M$ by

$$\pi_B(r_1, r_2, \dots) = \sum_{b \in B} r_b \cdot b$$

Note that the sum is finite since elements of $\bigoplus_{b \in B} R$ has finitely many non-zero components. It is clear that it is an R -module homomorphism. It is also surjective by definition of a generating set. By the first isomorphism theorem for module, we have that

$$\frac{\bigoplus_{b \in B} R}{\ker(\pi_B)} \cong M$$

and so we conclude. ■

The following is reminiscent of a theorem in linear algebra. However note that we require that R to be a division ring. Because we only dealt with finite dimensional vector spaces in Linear Algebra, we will need Zorn's lemma to deal with the case that the basis set has countable cardinality. Recall Zorn's lemma: If $(\mathcal{P}, \preceq)$ is a non empty poset such that every chain $P_1 \preceq P_2 \preceq \dots$ has an upper bound, then $(\mathcal{P}, \preceq)$ contains a maximal element.

Proposition 3.1.9

Let R be a division ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then the following are true.

- Every linearly independent subset $S \subseteq M$ can be extended to a basis
- Every generating set $Q \subseteq M$ contains a basis
- M is a free R -module

Proof

- Let S be a linearly independent set. Let $(\mathcal{P}, \subseteq)$ be the poset ordered by inclusion, where elements are subsets $S \subseteq X \subseteq M$ and that X is linearly independent. $\mathcal{P}$ is non empty since $S \in \mathcal{P}$. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a chain in $\mathcal{P}$. If $\mathcal{C}$ is empty, then any $X \in \mathcal{P}$ is an upper bound. So assume

that $\mathcal{C}$ is non-empty. Consider the set

$$T = \bigcup_{X \in \mathcal{C}} X$$

Clearly $X \subseteq T$ for all $X \in \mathcal{C}$. It remains to show that $T \in \mathcal{P}$.

Clearly $S \subseteq T$. We now want to show that T is a linearly independent set. Let $v_1, \dots, v_m \in T$ and $a_1, \dots, a_m \in R$ such that

$$\sum_{k=1}^m a_k v_k = 0$$

Since T is the union of $X \in \mathcal{C}$, each v_j belongs to some $X_j \in \mathcal{C}$. Since $\mathcal{C}$ is a chain, one of these sets, X_m contains all the other X_j . Thus $v_1, \dots, v_m \in X_m$. Since $X_m \in \mathcal{P}$, we conclude that $a_1 = \dots = a_m = 0$. Thus T is linearly independent so that $T \in \mathcal{P}$.

By Zorn's lemma, $\mathcal{P}$ has a maximal element Z . Suppose that Z does not span M . Then there exists $v \in M$ that is not a finite linear combination of elements of Z . Since Z is maximal, $Z \cup \{v\}$ does not belong to $\mathcal{P}$ and hence is linearly dependent. Thus there are $v_1, \dots, v_m \in Z$ and $a_1, \dots, a_m, a \in R$ not all 0 such that

$$\sum_{k=1}^m a_k v_k + av = 0$$

If $a = 0$ then we have linear dependence among $v_1, \dots, v_m$, a contradiction. Thus $a \neq 0$. Since R is a division ring, a has an inverse a^{-1} . Hence

$$v = -a^{-1}a_1v_1 - \dots - a^{-1}a_mv_m$$

This is a contradiction. Thus Z is a basis.

- Suppose that $(\mathcal{P}, \subseteq)$ is the poset under inclusion with elements of $\mathcal{P}$ being subsets $X \subseteq Q$ and X is linearly independent. Notice that $\emptyset \in \mathcal{P}$ so $\mathcal{P}$ is non empty. By a similar argument as above, we can conclude that $\mathcal{P}$ has an upper bound. By Zorn's lemma, $\mathcal{P}$ has a maximal element Z . It is linearly independent and is contained in Q . Now Z is a basis once we have shown that Z generates M . Since every $v \in M$ is a finite linear combination of elements of Q , we just have to express every $q \in Q$ as a linear combination of Z .

Suppose that this is false. Then there exists $q \in Q$ such that q is not a linear combination of Z . By a similar argument as above, $Z \cup \{q\}$ is a bigger element of $\mathcal{P}$, contradicting the fact that Z is maximal. Thus we are done.

- Either apply the first point with $S = \emptyset$ or apply the second point with $Q = M$.

This concludes the proof. ■

3.2 Finitely Generated Modules

Definition 3.2.1 (Finitely Generated Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. We say that M is finitely generated if M has a finite generating set.

This notion should be somewhat familiar to us. A finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -module is just a finitely generated abelian group. We have already classified all finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules by the fundamental theorem of finitely generated abelian groups.

On the other hand, a finitely generated k -module for a field k is exactly a finite dimensional vector space over k . We have already classified all finitely generated k -modules as they are isomorphic to k^n for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proposition 3.2.2

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule of M . If M is finitely generated, then M/N is finitely generated.

Proof Suppose that M is generated by the elements $m_1, \dots, m_k$. Let $p : M \rightarrow M/N$ be the projection map. It is in particular surjective. I claim that $m_1 + N, \dots, m_k + N$ generate M/N . Let $t + N \in M/N$. Since p is surjective, there exists $u \in M$ such that $p(u) = t + N$. Since M is finitely generated by $m_1, \dots, m_k$, we can write $u = r_1 m_1 + \dots + r_k m_k$. Then

$$t + N = p(u) = p(r_1 m_1 + \dots + r_k m_k) = r_1 p(m_1) + \dots + r_k p(m_k) = r_1 m_1 + N + \dots + r_k m_k + N$$

Hence every element of M/N can be written as an R -linear combination of $m_1 + N, \dots, m_k + N$. Hence M/N is finitely generated by $m_1 + N, \dots, m_k + N$. ■

Beware that $N \leq M$ may not be finitely generated even when M is finitely generated. For instance, the ring $R = \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n, \dots]$ is finitely generated by the element 1_R over itself. But the ideal $I = (x_1, \dots, x_n, \dots)$ (which is an R -submodule) is clearly not finitely generated.

Example 3.2.3 Consider the following abelian groups as $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules.

- $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ is not a finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.
- $\mathbb{Z}[[x]]$ is not a finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.
- $\mathbb{Q}$ is not a finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.
- $\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$ is not a finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.
- $\mathbb{R}$ is not a finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.

Proposition 3.2.4 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then M is finitely generated if and only if there exists a surjective homomorphism $R^n \rightarrow M$ for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

While free modules mimic the notion of a vector space, finitely generated free modules mirror the notion of finite dimensional vector spaces.

Proposition 3.2.5 Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. If M is finitely generated and free, then there is an isomorphism

$$M \cong R^n \cong R^{\oplus n}$$

for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proof When $R = 0$ then it is trivial. Suppose that $R \neq 0$. Let m be a maximal ideal of R . Since $M \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} R$ for some indexing set I , we can quotient m on both sides to deduce:

$$\frac{M}{mM} \cong \bigoplus_{i \in I} \frac{R}{m}$$

Now R/m is a division ring and it satisfies the invariant basis number property. Since M/mM is a free R/m -module, we conclude that any basis of M/mM and $\bigoplus_{i \in I} \frac{R}{m}$ has equal cardinality. Since M/mM is finitely generated, the basis of M is finite. Hence the indexing set I is finite, say $|I| = n$. Then $M \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^n R$ and so we are done. ■

Definition 3.2.6 (Cyclic Modules) Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. We say that M is cyclic if M is generated by one element.

Lemma 3.2.7 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then M is cyclic if and only if there exists an ideal I of R such that $M \cong R/I$ as left R -modules.

Proof Clearly R/I is generated by the element $1 + I$. Hence $M \cong R/I$ is cyclic. Conversely, suppose that M is cyclic. Consider the R -module homomorphism $R \rightarrow M$ defined by $r \mapsto rx$. It is surjective since $M = R \cdot x$. Moreover, its kernel is an ideal. Hence $M \cong R/I$. ■

3.3 Invariant Basis Number Property

Definition 3.3.1 (Invariant Basis Number Property)

Let R be a ring. We say that R has the invariant basis number (IBN) property if $R^m \cong R^n$ implies $m = n$.

Definition 3.3.2 (Rank of a Free Module)

Let R be a ring. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}^+$. Define the rank of R^n to be n .

The notion of rank is not well defined if the ring is not IBN.

Proposition 3.3.3 Every division ring is an IBN-ring.

Proposition 3.3.4 Every commutative ring is an IBN-ring.

Proof Let R be a commutative ring. Let m be a maximal ideal of R . Suppose that $R^k \cong R^n$. Then $(R/m)^k \cong (R/m)^n$ as vector spaces over R/m . Hence $k = n$. Thus R is an IBN-ring. ■

Proposition 3.3.5 Let $f : R \rightarrow S$ be a surjective non zero ring homomorphism. Let S be an IBN-ring. Then R is also an IBN-ring.

4 Exact Sequences of Modules

4.1 Introduction to Exact Sequences

Exact sequences give a compact way of expressing a sequence of homomorphisms and modules.

Definition 4.1.1 (Long Exact Sequences) Let R be a ring. Let M_k be a left R -module for each $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Let $f_k : M_k \rightarrow M_{k-1}$ be R -module homomorphisms for each $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. We say that the sequence

$$\cdots \longrightarrow M_{k+1} \xrightarrow{f_{k+1}} M_k \xrightarrow{f_k} M_{k-1} \longrightarrow \cdots$$

is exact if $\text{im}(f_{k+1}) = \ker(f_k)$ for all $k \in \mathbb{Z}$.

We are particularly interested in a special type of long exact sequences: Those that has 3 consecutively non-negative terms.

Definition 4.1.2 (Short Exact Sequences) Let R be a ring. A short exact sequence of R -modules is a long exact sequence consisting of 3 consecutive non-zero terms in the sequence. Explicitly, it is given by

$$0 \longrightarrow M_1 \xrightarrow{f} M_2 \xrightarrow{g} M_3 \longrightarrow 0$$

for M_1, M_2, M_3 being R -modules and $f : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ and $g : M_2 \rightarrow M_3$ being R -module homomorphisms.

Lemma 4.1.3 Let R be a ring. Let M_1, M_2, M_3 be R -modules. Let $f : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ and $g : M_2 \rightarrow M_3$ be R -module homomorphisms. Then the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow M_1 \xrightarrow{f} M_2 \xrightarrow{g} M_3 \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact if and only if the following are true.

- f is injective.
- g is surjective.
- $\text{im}(f) = \ker(g)$.

Lemma 4.1.4 Let R be a ring. Let M_1, M_2, M_3 be R -modules. Let $f : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ and $g : M_2 \rightarrow M_3$ be R -module homomorphisms such that

$$0 \longrightarrow M_1 \xrightarrow{f} M_2 \xrightarrow{g} M_3 \longrightarrow 0$$

is a short exact sequence. Then the following are true.

- $M_1 \cong \ker(g)$
- $M_3 \cong \text{coker}(f) = \frac{M_3}{\text{im}(f)}$

Proof Since f is injective, by the first isomorphism theorem we conclude that $A \cong \text{im}(f)$. By exactness, $\text{im}(f) = \ker(g)$ so that $A \cong \ker(g)$.

Since g is surjective, by the first isomorphism theorem we conclude that $\frac{B}{\ker(g)} \cong C$. By exactness, $\text{im}(f) = \ker(g)$ and so we conclude. ■

From the above we can deduce that whenever we see the following sequences:

$$0 \longrightarrow \ker(g) \xhookrightarrow{\iota} B \xrightarrow{g} C \longrightarrow 0$$

$$0 \longrightarrow A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{q} \frac{B}{\operatorname{im}(f)} \longrightarrow 0$$

are exact by definition.

Proposition 4.1.5 Let R be a ring. Let the following be a long exact sequence of R -modules.

$$\cdots \longrightarrow M_{k+1} \xrightarrow{f_{k+1}} M_k \xrightarrow{f_k} M_{k-1} \longrightarrow \cdots$$

Then for all $i \in \mathbb{Z}$, there are short exact sequences of the form

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{im}(f_{i+1}) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{incl.}} M_i \xrightarrow{f_i} \operatorname{im}(f_i) \longrightarrow 0$$

Proof Suppose we are given the long exact sequence and consider the 3 term sequence below. It is clear that the inclusion map is injective. Similarly, the map $f_i : M_i \rightarrow \operatorname{im}(f_i)$ is surjective tautologically. Finally, $\ker(f_i) = \operatorname{im}(f_{i+1})$ from the long exact sequence. ■

Proposition 4.1.6 Let R be a ring. Suppose that for each $i \in \mathbb{Z}$, we have a short exact sequence of the form

$$0 \longrightarrow N_{i+1} \xrightarrow{g_i} M_i \xrightarrow{h_i} N_i \longrightarrow 0$$

Then the following sequence of R -modules

$$\cdots \longrightarrow M_{k+1} \xrightarrow{g_i \circ h_{i+1}} M_k \xrightarrow{g_{i-1} \circ h_i} M_{k-1} \longrightarrow \cdots$$

is a long exact sequence.

Proof Since h_i is surjective, we have that $\operatorname{im}(g_i \circ h_{i+1}) = \operatorname{im}(g_i)$. Similarly, since g_i is injective, we have that $\ker(g_{i-1} \circ h_i) = \ker(h_i)$. But from the short exact sequence we know that $\operatorname{im}(g_i) = \ker(h_i)$. Hence we have

$$\operatorname{im}(g_i \circ h_{i+1}) = \operatorname{im}(g_i) = \ker(h_i) = \ker(g_{i-1} \circ h_i)$$

so that we have a long exact sequence. ■

It is convenient to think of the exchange as follows. We can intersperse $\operatorname{im}(f_i)$ to obtain a new sequence

$$\cdots \longrightarrow M_{i+1} \xrightarrow{\operatorname{surj.}} \operatorname{im}(f_{i+1}) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{inj.}} M_i \xrightarrow{\operatorname{surj.}} \operatorname{im}(f_i) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{inj.}} M_{i-1} \longrightarrow \cdots$$

that is NOT exact unless we fold up each pair of surjective map followed by an injective map into a single map. On the otherhand, we can ignore all other terms in the sequence except for an injective map followed by a surjective map. This will give us a short exact sequence.

The following two lemmas are very intuitive and straight forward to remember.

Lemma 4.1.7 (Five Lemma) Let R be a ring. Consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} A & \xrightarrow{f} & B & \xrightarrow{g} & C & \xrightarrow{h} & D & \xrightarrow{j} & E \\ \downarrow l & & \downarrow m & & \downarrow n & & \downarrow p & & \downarrow q \\ A' & \xrightarrow{r} & B' & \xrightarrow{s} & C' & \xrightarrow{t} & D' & \xrightarrow{u} & E' \end{array}$$

where all the objects are R -modules. Suppose that the following are true.

- The two rows are exact
- $m : B \rightarrow B'$ and $p : D \rightarrow D'$ are isomorphisms

- $l : A \rightarrow A'$ is surjective
- $q : E \rightarrow E'$ is injective

Then n is an isomorphism.

Proof For injectivity,

Let $c \in \ker(n)$. Then $n(c) = 0$. By commutativity, we have that

$$p(h(c)) = t(n(c)) = t(0) = 0$$

Since p is an isomorphism, then $h(c) = 0$ and $c \in \ker(h)$. By exactness, we have that $c \in \ker(h) = \text{im}(g)$. Thus there exists $b \in B$ such that $g(b) = c$. Now by commutativity, we have that

$$s(m(b)) = n(g(b)) = n(c) = 0$$

so that $m(b) \in \ker(s)$. By exactness, we have that $m(b) \in \ker(s) = \text{im}(r)$. Thus there exists $a' \in A'$ such that $r(a') = m(b)$. By surjectivity of l , there exists $a \in A$ such that $l(a) = a'$. By commutativity, we have that

$$m(f(a)) = r(l(a)) = r(a') = m(b)$$

Since m is an isomorphism, $f(a) = b$. Then by exactness, $\ker(g) = \text{im}(f)$ implies

$$0 = g(f(a))g(b) = c$$

Thus $c = 0$ and so n is injective.

For surjectivity,

Let $c' \in C'$. By exactness, we have that $u(t(c')) = 0$. Since p is an isomorphism, there exists $d \in D$ such that $p(d) = t(c')$. By commutativity, we have that

$$q(j(d)) = u(p(d)) = u(t(c')) = 0$$

Since q is injective, $j(d) = 0$. So $d \in \ker(j)$. By exactness, $d \in \ker(j) = \text{im}(h)$. Thus there exists $c \in C$ such that $h(c) = d$. By commutativity, we have that

$$t(n(c)) = p(h(c)) = p(d) = t(c')$$

Thus $t(n(c) - c') = 0$ and $n(c) - c' \in \ker(t)$. By exactness, $n(c) - c' \in \ker(t) = \text{im}(s)$. So there exists $b' \in B'$ such that $s(b') = n(c) - c'$. Since m is an isomorphism, there exists $b \in B$ such that $m(b) = b'$. By commutativity, we have that

$$n(g(b)) = s(m(b)) = n(c) - c'$$

Now $n(g(b) - c) = c'$ and so we have proven surjectivity. ■

The proof is long but is rather straight forward. In every step there is only one possible way to advance, and so one eventually arrives at the conclusion.

Lemma 4.1.8 (Snake Lemma) Let R be a ring. Consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} A & \xrightarrow{f} & B & \xrightarrow{g} & C & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & \downarrow a & & \downarrow b & & \downarrow c & \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & A' & \xrightarrow{f'} & B' & \xrightarrow{g'} & C' \end{array}$$

where all the objects are R -modules. If the two rows are exact, then there is an exact sequence relating the kernels and cokernels of a, b, c

$$\ker(a) \longrightarrow \ker(b) \longrightarrow \ker(c) \xrightarrow{d} \operatorname{coker}(a) \longrightarrow \operatorname{coker}(b) \longrightarrow \operatorname{coker}(c)$$

where d is called the connecting homomorphism.

Proof We construct the function d as follows.

- Let $k \in \ker(c)$.
- By exactness, g is surjective. Thus there exists $l \in B$ such that $g(l) = k$.
- But $g'(b(l)) = c(g(l)) = c(k) = 0$ which means that $b(l) \in \ker(g')$. By exactness, there exists $m \in A'$ such that $f'(m) = b(l)$ since $\operatorname{im}(f') = \ker(g')$. This m is unique since f' is injective. In particular, $[m] \in \operatorname{coker}(a)$.

We then define $d : \ker(c) \rightarrow \operatorname{coker}(a)$ by $d(k) = m$.

We need to show that d is well defined. Suppose that l' is another element in B such that $g(l') = k$. Then $g(l - l') = 0$ so that $l - l' \in \ker(g)$. By exactness, $\operatorname{im}(f) = \ker(g)$ so there is some $n \in A$ such that $f(n) = l - l'$. By a similar argument as the first paragraph, one can find $m' \in A'$ such that $f'(m') = b(l')$. Then

$$f'(a(n)) = b(f(n)) = b(l - l') = b(l) - b(l') = f'(m) - f'(m')$$

Since f' is injective by exactness, we have that $a(n) = m - m'$ so that $m - m' \in \operatorname{im}(a)$ and hence $[m] = [m']$. Thus d is a well defined map.

Since all operations above are R -module homomorphisms, d is also an R -module homomorphism.

It remains to show exactness of the sequence. ■

Lemma 4.1.9 Let the following be an exact sequence of abelian groups.

$$0 \longrightarrow A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C \longrightarrow 0$$

Then $\operatorname{rank}(B) = \operatorname{rank}(A) + \operatorname{rank}(C)$.

Lemma 4.1.10 Let the following be an exact sequence of vector spaces.

$$0 \longrightarrow V \xrightarrow{f} W \xrightarrow{g} U \longrightarrow 0$$

Then $\dim(W) = \dim(V) + \dim(U)$.

4.2 Split Exact Sequences

Definition 4.2.1 (Split Exact Sequence) Let R be a ring. Let the following be an exact sequence of R -modules.

$$0 \longrightarrow M_1 \xrightarrow{f} M_2 \xrightarrow{g} M_3 \longrightarrow 0$$

We say that the sequence is split exact if $M_2 \cong M_1 \oplus M_3$.

The following is an important equivalent characterization of split exact sequence.

Proposition 4.2.2 (The Splitting Lemma) Let R be a ring. Let the following be an exact sequence of R -modules.

$$0 \longrightarrow A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C \longrightarrow 0$$

Then the following are equivalent.

- The short exact sequence is a split exact sequence
- There exists an R -module homomorphism $p : B \rightarrow A$ such that $p \circ f = \text{id}_A$
- There exists an R -module homomorphism $s : C \rightarrow B$ such that $g \circ s = \text{id}_C$

Proof

- (1) $\implies$ (2), (3): Suppose that $B \cong A \oplus C$. Then the projection map $p : A \oplus C \rightarrow A$ and the inclusion map $s : C \rightarrow A \oplus C$ is such that $p \circ f = \text{id}_A$ and $g \circ s = \text{id}_C$.
- (2) $\implies$ (1): For any $b \in B$, write $b = f(p(b)) + (b - f(p(b)))$. Then $f(p(b)) \in \text{im}(f)$ and $b - f(p(b)) \in \ker(p)$ since $p(b - f(p(b))) = p(b) - p(b) = 0$. Now I claim that $\ker(p) \cap \text{im}(f) = 0$. Indeed if $b \in \ker(p) \cap \text{im}(f)$, then there exists $a \in A$ such that $f(a) = b$. Then

$$a = p(f(a)) = p(b) = 0$$

Thus $b = f(0) = 0$. This shows that $B \cong \ker(p) \oplus \text{im}(f)$.

Consider the restricted $g|_{\ker(p)} : \ker(p) \rightarrow C$. I want to show that g is an isomorphism. Let $b \in \ker(g|_{\ker(p)})$. By exactness, there exists $a \in A$ such that $f(a) = b$. Then $a = p(f(a)) = p(b) = 0$ since $b \in \ker(p)$. Thus $b = f(0) = 0$ so that $b \in \ker(g|_{\ker(p)})$. For surjectivity, let $c \in C$. By exactness, g is surjective so there exists $b \in B$ such that $g(b) = c$. Since $B \cong \ker(p) \oplus \text{im}(f)$, we can write $b = f(a) + k$ for some $a \in A$ and $k \in \ker(p)$. Then we have that

$$c = g(b) = g(f(a) + k) = g(k)$$

which means that there exists $k \in \ker(p)$ such that $g|_{\ker(p)}(k) = c$. Thus $\ker(p) \cong C$. Since f is injective, $\text{im}(f) = f(A) \cong A$. Thus we have that $B \cong \text{im}(f) \oplus \ker(p) \cong A \oplus C$.

- (3) $\implies$ (1): For any $b \in B$, write $b = (b - s(g(b))) + s(g(b))$. Then $s(g(b)) \in \text{im}(s)$ and $g(b) = g(b) - g(s(g(b))) = 0$ so that $b - s(g(b)) \in \ker(g)$. Now I claim that $\ker(g) \cap \text{im}(s) = 0$. Indeed if $b \in \ker(g) \cap \text{im}(s)$, then there exists $c \in C$ such that $s(c) = b$ and

$$c = g(s(c)) = g(b) = 0$$

since $b \in \ker(g)$ so that $c = 0$. This shows that $B \cong \ker(g) \oplus \text{im}(s)$.

Since $\ker(g) = \text{im}(f)$ by exactness, f being injective also implies that $A \cong \text{im}(f) = \ker(g)$. Since also we have that $g \circ s = \text{id}_C$, we have that s is injective so that $\text{im}(s) \cong C$. Thus we conclude that $B \cong \ker(g) \oplus \text{im}(s) \cong A \oplus C$.

Thus we conclude. ■

Proposition 4.2.3 Let R be a ring. Let the following be an exact sequence of R -modules.

$$0 \longrightarrow A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C \longrightarrow 0$$

If C is a free R -module then it is a split exact sequence.

Proof Since C is a free R -module, there exists a basis $X = \{c_1, \dots, c_n\}$ such that $C = \bigoplus_{i=1}^n Rc_i$. Since g is surjective, we can find $b_1, \dots, b_n \in B$ such that $g(b_i) = c_i$ for $1 \leq i \leq n$. By the universal property of free R -modules, there exists an R -module homomorphism $s : C \rightarrow B$ such that $s(c_i) = b_i$ for $1 \leq i \leq n$. Now notice that for $c \in C$, we can write $c = \sum_{i=1}^n k_i c_i$ for some $k_i \in \mathbb{Z}$. Since s is an R -module homomorphism, we have that $s(\sum_{i=1}^n k_i c_i) = \sum_{i=1}^n k_i b_i$. Then we have that

$$g(s(c)) = g\left(\sum_{i=1}^n k_i b_i\right) = \sum_{i=1}^n k_i c_i$$

Thus $g \circ s = \text{id}_C$. By the splitting lemma, we conclude that $B \cong A \oplus C$. ■

5 Algebras over a Ring

5.1 Associative Algebras

Definition 5.1.1 (Associative Algebras)

Let R be a commutative ring. An R -algebra is a ring $(A, +, \times)$ such that $(A, +)$ is an R -module and that the following distributivity law is satisfied:

$$r \cdot (x \times y) = (r \cdot x) \times y = x \times (r \cdot y)$$

for all $r \in R$ and $x, y \in A$.

A prototypical example of an algebra would be a ring itself. Indeed for a ring R , R is a left R -module via the action of left multiplication.

Proposition 5.1.2

Let R be a commutative ring. Then the following are equivalent characterizations of an R -algebra.

- A is an R -algebra.
- A is a ring together with a ring homomorphism $f : R \rightarrow A$ such that $f(R) \subseteq Z(A)$.

This establishes a one-to-one correspondence

$$\left\{ (A, R) \mid A \text{ is an } R\text{-algebra} \right\} \xleftrightarrow{1:1} \left\{ \phi : R \rightarrow A \mid \begin{array}{l} \phi \text{ is a ring homomorphism} \\ \text{such that } f(R) \subseteq Z(A) \end{array} \right\}$$

Notice that when R is a field, the algebra A becomes a vector space over R .

Example 5.1.3

Let R be a ring. Then R is an algebra over $\mathbb{Z}$.

Example 5.1.4

$\mathbb{C}$ is an $\mathbb{R}$ -algebra whose module structure is given by multiplication.

Example 5.1.5

Let R be a commutative ring. Then the following are true.

- $M_n(R)$ is an R -algebra.
- Let M be an R -module. Then $\text{End}_R(M)$ is an R -algebra.

Example 5.1.6

Let R be a commutative ring. Then $R[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ is an R -algebra.

Definition 5.1.7 (R-Subalgebra) Let R be a commutative ring. Let A be an R -algebra. An R -subalgebra of A is a subring of A which is also an R -algebra in its own right.

Proposition 5.1.8 Let R be a commutative ring. Let A be an R -algebra. Then any left, right or two-sided ideals of A is an R -subalgebra of A .

5.2 Algebra Homomorphisms

Definition 5.2.1 (R-Algebra Homomorphisms)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A, B be R -algebras. Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be a function. We say that f is an R -algebra homomorphism if the following are true.

- f is an R -linear map: $f(rx + sy) = rf(x) + sf(y)$ for $x, y \in A$ and $r, s \in R$
- f is a ring homomorphism: $f(xy) = f(x)f(y)$ for $x, y \in A$

Definition 5.2.2 (R-Algebra Isomorphisms)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A, B be R -algebras. Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be an R -algebra homomorphism. We say that f is an R -algebra isomorphism if there exists an R -algebra homomorphism $g : B \rightarrow A$ such that

$$g \circ f = \text{id}_A \quad \text{and} \quad f \circ g = \text{id}_B$$

Definition 5.2.3 (The Kernel of a Homomorphism)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A, B be R -algebras. Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be an R -algebra homomorphism. Define the kernel of f to be

$$\ker(f) = \{x \in A \mid f(x) = 0\}$$

Definition 5.2.4 (Quotient Algebras)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A be an R -algebra. Let I be a two sided ideal of A . Define the quotient of A by I to be the R -algebra

$$A/I = \{x + I \mid x \in A\}$$

5.3 Isomorphism Theorems for Algebra**Theorem 5.3.1 (The First Isomorphism Theorem for Algebras)**

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A, B be R -algebras. Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be an R -algebra homomorphism. Then the following are true.

- $\ker(f)$ is a two sided ideal of A .
- $\text{im}(f)$ is an R -subalgebra of B .
- There is an R -algebra isomorphism

$$\frac{A}{\ker(f)} \cong \text{im}(f)$$

given by the function $x + \ker(f) \mapsto f(x)$.

Example 5.3.2

There is an $\mathbb{R}$ -algebra isomorphism

$$\frac{\mathbb{R}[x]}{(x^2 + 1)} \cong \mathbb{C}$$

given by the first isomorphism theorem applied to the map $\mathbb{R}[x] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ defined by $f \mapsto f(i)$.

Theorem 5.3.3 (The Second Isomorphism Theorem for Algebras)**5.4 New Algebras from Old****Proposition 5.4.1**

Let R be a commutative ring. Let $\{A_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a collection of R -algebras. Then the following are true.

- $\prod_{i \in I} A_i$ is an R -algebra.
- $\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i$ is an R -algebra.

Proposition 5.4.2

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A_1, A_2 be R -algebras. Then $A_1 \otimes_R A_2$ is an R -algebra.

5.5 Free Algebras

Definition 5.5.1 (Free Algebra) Let R be a commutative ring. Let X be a set. Let $W = \{x_1 \cdots x_n \mid x_1, \dots, x_n \in X\}$ be the set of words of X . Define the free R -algebra over X to be the free R -module

$$R\langle X \rangle = \bigoplus_{w \in W} R \cdot w$$

together with multiplication defined by $(x_1 \cdots x_n) \cdot (y_1 \cdots y_m) = x_1 \cdots x_n \cdot y_1 \cdots y_m$.

Proposition 5.5.2 (Universal Property) Let R be a commutative ring. Let X be a set. The free algebra $R\langle X \rangle$ over a ring R satisfies the following universal property. If A is an R -algebra, then for every $f : X \rightarrow A$ a map of sets, there exists a unique homomorphism of algebras $\varphi : R\langle X \rangle \rightarrow A$ such that $\varphi(x_i) = f(x_i)$ for each $x_i \in X$. In other words, the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xhookrightarrow{\iota} & R\langle X \rangle \\ & \searrow f & \downarrow \exists! \varphi \\ & & A \end{array}$$

where $\iota : X \rightarrow R\langle X \rangle$ is the inclusion.

Proof Consider the set of monomials over elements of X . They form a basis of $R\langle X \rangle$ as an R -module. For a monomial $x_{i_1} \cdots x_{i_m}$, define

$$\varphi(x_{i_1} \cdots x_{i_m}) = f(x_{i_1}) \cdots f(x_{i_m})$$

and extend it by R -linearity. Then it is clear that φ is a well defined algebra homomorphism that satisfies the theorem. Any other homomorphism as in the theorem must satisfy the above conditions thus φ is unique. $\blacksquare$

5.6 Modules over Algebras

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A be an R -algebra. Let M be an A -module. Then M is also an R -module via restriction of scalars. We are interested in the finiteness conditions of M as an A -module and as an R -module.

Proposition 5.6.1

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A be an R -algebra that is a finitely generated R -module. Let M be an A -module. Then M is a finitely generated R -module if and only if M is a finitely generated A -module.

5.7 Algebras over a Group

Definition 5.7.1 (Group Ring)

Let G be a group. Let R be a commutative ring. Define the group ring $R[G]$ to be the R -module

$$R[G] = \bigoplus_{g \in G} R \cdot g$$

together with multiplication defined by

$$\left(\sum_{g \in G} \lambda_g g \right) \cdot \left(\sum_{h \in G} \mu_h h \right) = \sum_{g, h \in G} (\lambda_g \mu_h) gh$$

Lemma 5.7.2

Let G be a group. Let R be a commutative ring. Then the following are true regarding the group ring $R[G]$.

- $R[G]$ is an R -algebra.
- If G is abelian, then $R[G]$ is commutative.
- If G is finite, then $R[G]$ is a finite algebra (finitely generated R -module).
- If G is finitely generated, then $R[G]$ is a finitely generated R -algebra.

Example 5.7.3

Let R be a commutative ring. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}^+$. There is an R -algebra isomorphism

$$\frac{R[x]}{(x^n - 1)} \cong R[C_n]$$

5.8 Derivations of Algebras

Definition 5.8.1 (Derivations) Let A be a ring and B an A -algebra. Let M be a B -module. An A -derivation of B into M is an A -module homomorphism $d : B \rightarrow M$ such that the Leibniz rule holds:

$$d(b_1 b_2) = b_1 d(b_2) + d(b_1) b_2$$

for $b_1, b_2 \in B$. Denote the set of all A -derivations from B to M by

$$\text{Der}_A(B, M) = \{d : B \rightarrow M \mid d \text{ is an } A \text{ derivation}\}$$

This is reminiscent of properties of a derivative. Indeed, from the above definition, take $A = \mathbb{R}$ and $B = M = \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n]$. Then the formal partial derivatives $\frac{\partial}{\partial x_i} : \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ defined by

$$\left(f(x) = \sum_{k_1, \dots, k_n} a_{k_1, \dots, k_n} x_1^{k_1} \cdots x_i^{k_i} \cdots x_n^{k_n} \right) \mapsto \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i} = \sum_{k_1, \dots, k_n} a_{k_1, \dots, k_n} k_i x_1^{k_1} \cdots x_i^{k_i-1} \cdots x_n^{k_n} \right)$$

(provided $k_i \geq 1$, otherwise the derivative is constant on that term) is $\mathbb{R}$ -linear and satisfies the Leibniz rule. These are the two fundamental properties that a derivative should possess.

Definition 5.8.2 (The Module of Derivations) Let A be a ring and B an A -algebra. Let M be a B -module. Define the B -module of derivations to be the set

$$\text{Der}_A(B, M) = \{d : B \rightarrow M \mid d \text{ is a derivation of } A\}$$

together with the following operations:

- Addition is defined by sending $d_1, d_2 : B \rightarrow M$ to $(d_1 + d_2) : B \rightarrow M$ that maps b to $d_1(b) + d_2(b)$.
- Left action is defined by $\cdot : B \times \text{Der}_A(B, M) \rightarrow \text{Der}_A(B, M)$ that sends $b \in B$ and $d : B \rightarrow M$ to $(bd) : B \rightarrow M$ defined by $u \mapsto b \cdot d(u)$.

Lemma 5.8.3 Let A be a ring and B an A -algebra. Let M be a B -module. Then $\text{Der}_A(B, M)$ is indeed a B -module with the given operations.

Proof Firstly, $\text{Der}_A(B, M)$ is an abelian group. We check the group axioms.

- Closure: Let $a \in A$ and $b_1, b_2 \in B$. $d_1 + d_2 : B \rightarrow M$ is an A -module homomorphism because

$$\begin{aligned} (d_1 + d_2)(ab_1 + b_2) &= d_1(ab_1 + b_2) + d_2(ab_1 + b_2) \\ &= ad_1(b_1) + d_1(b_2) + ad_2(b_1) + d_2(b_2) \\ &= a(d_1 + d_2)(b_1) + (d_1 + d_2)(b_2) \end{aligned}$$

Finally, the Leibniz rule is satisfied because

$$\begin{aligned}(d_1 + d_2)(b_1 b_2) &= d_1(b_1 b_2) + d_2(b_1 b_2) \\ &= b_1 d_1(b_2) + d_1(b_1) b_2 + b_1 d_2(b_2) + d_2(b_1) b_2 \\ &= b_1(d_1 + d_2)(b_2) + (d_1 + d_2)(b_1) b_2\end{aligned}$$

- Associativity: Follows from the fact that M is a group
- Identity: The zero map is the identity since for any $d : B \rightarrow M$, $d + 0 : B \rightarrow M$ sends b to $d(b)$ and thus $d + 0 = d$.
- Inverse: For each $d : B \rightarrow M$ the maps sending b to $-d(b)$ is an inverse
- Abelian: Follows from the fact that M is abelian.

Finally, left action is defined by $\cdot : B \times \text{Der}_A(B, M) \rightarrow \text{Der}_A(B, M)$ that sends $b \in B$ and $d : B \rightarrow M$ to $(bd) : B \rightarrow M$ defined by $u \mapsto b \cdot d(u)$. Associativity and identity is clear. ■

Derivatives in analysis also satisfy the quotient rule and the fact that constant maps have 0 derivative. The following lemma shows that instead of defining derivatives for it so that constant maps have 0 derivative, it is in fact a consequence of linearity and Leibniz rule.

Lemma 5.8.4 Let A be a ring and B an A -algebra. Let M be a B -module. Let $d : B \rightarrow M$ be an A -derivation. Then $d(a) = 0$ for all $a \in A$.

Proof Since $d : B \rightarrow M$ is an A -module homomorphism, $d(a \cdot 1) = a \cdot d(1)$. We also have, by the Leibniz rule that $d(1) = 1 \cdot d(1) + d(1) \cdot 1 = 2d(1)$ which implies $d(1) = 0$. Thus $d(a \cdot 1) = a \cdot d(1) = 0$. ■

As mentioned above, derivatives in analysis also satisfy the quotient rule. However, one must be careful in the question of existence of the quotient rule given the Leibniz rule because first of all B and M may not formally have quotients since they are not fields. Instead, what one can do is to pass on the derivative to the fraction field so that quotients are well defined. Interested readers are referred to [?].

The set of all derivations itself also has an extra structure of being a B -module in its own right.

We can see that $\text{Der}_{\mathbb{R}}(\mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n], \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n])$ has more than just the standard partial derivatives from the module structure. For examples, the sum of partial derivatives

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x_i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} : \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n]$$

defined by $f \mapsto \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_j}$.

However, second order derivatives (which are compositions of the first order partial derivatives) are not derivations! Indeed they satisfy not the Leibniz property but instead, we have that

$$\frac{\partial(fg)}{\partial x_i x_j} = \frac{\partial}{\partial x_i} \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_j} g + f \frac{\partial g}{\partial x_j} \right) = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_i x_j} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_j} \frac{\partial g}{\partial x_i} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i} \frac{\partial g}{\partial x_j} + \frac{\partial^2 g}{\partial x_i x_j}$$

which is way more complicated!

Finally, there is one more example of derivations. While we have done a completely general treatment of partial derivatives above, we can in fact evaluate the derivative at a chosen point and it will again be an $\mathbb{R}$ -derivation. Writing $f(p) = \text{ev}_p(f)$ where ev is the evaluation homomorphism, the $\mathbb{R}$ -derivation

$\mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ defined by

$$f \mapsto \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i} g(p) + f(p) \frac{\partial g}{\partial x_i}$$

is also a derivation!

5.9 The Enveloping Algebra

Definition 5.9.1 (The Enveloping Algebra)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A be an R -algebra. Define the enveloping algebra of A to be

$$A^e = A \otimes_R A^{\text{op}}$$

Lemma 5.9.2

Let R be a commutative ring. Let A be an R -algebra. Let M be a set. Then M is an A -bimodule if and only if M is a left A^e -module.

6 The Basic Building Blocks of a Module

6.1 Simple Modules

Definition 6.1.1 (Simple Module)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. We say that M is simple if the following are true.

- $M \neq \{0\}$.
- The only sub-modules of M are $\{0\}$ and M .

Lemma 6.1.2

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. If M is simple, then M is cyclic.

Proof If not, then for any $0 \neq x \in M$, we have that $R \cdot x$ is an R -submodule of M . ■

Lemma 6.1.3

Let R be a ring. If $L \subseteq R$ is a maximal left ideal, then the left R -module R/L is simple.

Proof By the correspondence theorem, ideals of R/L are in 1-1 correspondence to ideals of R that contains L . Since L is maximal, there exists no such ideals. Thus R/L has no ideals and thus no R -submodule. ■

Recall that every ring has a maximal left ideal. As a result, we can prove the existence of a simple left R -module for any ring R .

Corollary 6.1.4

Every non-zero ring R has a simple left R -module.

Proof Since every ring R has a maximal left ideal L , R/L is a non-trivial simple R -module by lemma 2.7.2. ■

Proposition 6.1.5

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then M is simple if and only if there exists a maximal left ideal m of R such that $M \cong R/m$ as R -modules.

Proof We know that R/m is simple. If there is an isomorphism $M \cong R/m$ then this means that M is simple. Conversely, suppose that M is simple. Then M must be cyclic, and so $M \cong R/I$ for some ideal I . If I is not maximal, then there exists a proper ideal J of R such that $I \subset J \subset R$. By the correspondence theorem, J/I is an R -submodule of R/I , and hence M has an R -submodule, a contradiction. ■

Proposition 6.1.6 (Schur's Lemma I)

Let R be a ring. Let M, N simple be left R -modules. Let $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ be an R -module homomorphism. Then $\phi = 0$ or ϕ is an isomorphism.

Proof

Suppose that $\phi \neq 0$. Since $\ker(\phi)$ is a submodule of M and M is simple, we must have that $\ker(\phi) = 0$. Then we must have that $\text{im}(\phi)$ is a non-trivial submodule of N . But since N is simple, $\text{im}(\phi) = N$. Thus ϕ is a bijection. ■

Corollary 6.1.7 (Schur's Lemma II)

Let R be a ring. If M is a simple left R -module, then $\text{End}_R(M)$ is a division ring.

Proof Let $\phi \in \text{End}_R(M)$ be non-zero. Since M is simple, Schur's lemma I tells us that ϕ is an isomorphism. Then it has an inverse. ■

Theorem 6.1.8 (Baby Artin-Wedderburn Theorem)

Let R be a non-zero ring. Then every left R -module is free if and only if R is a division ring.

Proof If R is a division ring, then every left R -module has basis by theorem 2.6.5. Now suppose that R is a non-zero ring such that every left R -module is free. By corollary 2.7.4, there exists a simple left R -module M . Let x be a basis element of M .

Consider the homomorphism $\pi : R \rightarrow M$ defined by $\pi(r) = rx$. Then $\ker(\pi) = 0$ otherwise there would be a linear dependency on the basis element x . Since $\text{im}(\pi)$ is a non-zero submodule of M , a simple module, $\text{im}(\pi) = M$. By the first isomorphism theorem, $M \cong R$ as left R -modules. By lemma 2.4.3, we have an isomorphism

$$\text{End}_R(M) \cong \text{End}_R(R) \cong R$$

of rings. By Schur's lemma II, we have that $\text{End}_R(M) \cong R$ is a division ring. ■

6.2 Semisimple Modules

Definition 6.2.1 (Semisimple Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. We say that M is semisimple if M is a direct sum of simple modules.

It is clear that every simple module is a semisimple module. But beware that the notion of simplicity for a ring often does not coincide. For instance, one can say that a ring is simple if the only two sided ideals are (0) and itself. One can also consider a ring to be simple if it is simple as a left R -module. In this case, the condition transfers to the only left ideals of R are (0) and itself.

All this is to say that simple rings and semisimple rings could mean different things, depending on the context.

Definition 6.2.2 (Socle of a Module)

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Define the socle of M to be

$$\text{soc}(M) = \sum_{\substack{S \text{ is a simple} \\ \text{submodule}}} S$$

Proposition 6.2.3 A module M is semisimple if and only if $\text{soc}(M) = M$.

Proof Suppose that M is semisimple. Then M is a direct sum of simple submodules so that $M = \text{soc}(M)$.

Now suppose that $\text{soc}(M) = M$. Then $M = \sum_{i \in I} S_i$ is the internal direct product of some simple submodules of M . Consider the poset

$$\mathcal{P} = \left\{ X \subseteq I \mid \sum_{i \in X} S_i \text{ is a direct sum} \right\}$$

ordered by inclusion. In particular, recall from Rings and Modules that $X \in \mathcal{P}$ if and only if

$\phi : \bigoplus_{i \in X} S_i \rightarrow M$ defined by $\phi((m_i)_{i \in X}) = \sum_{i \in X} m_i$ is injective. The kernel of ϕ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \ker(\phi) &= \left\{ (m_i)_{i \in X} \mid \sum_{i \in X} m_i = 0 \right\} \\ &= \left\{ (m_i)_{i \in X} \mid \text{for all } i_1, \dots, i_k \in X \text{ we have } m_{i_1} + \dots + m_{i_k} = 0 \right\} \end{aligned}$$

The kernel being trivial is equivalent to the condition that for all $i_1, \dots, i_k \in X$ and all $m_{i_t} \in S_{i_t}$, we have $m_{i_1} + \dots + m_{i_k} = 0$ implies $m_{i_1} = \dots = m_{i_k} = 0$. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a chain in $\mathcal{P}$. It is clear that $T = \bigcup_{Z \in \mathcal{C}} Z$ is an upper bound of $\mathcal{C}$. Indeed if the above condition fails, then it fails on some finitely many elements x_i which are contained in $X \subseteq Z \subseteq T$. By Zorn's lemma, $\mathcal{P}$ has a maximal element J . We know that $N = \sum_{i \in J} S_i$ is actually a direct sum. It remains to show that $N = M$.

If this is false, then there exists S_k not a subset of N . In particular, $k \neq J$. Consider the set $J \cup \{k\}$. In particular the above condition fails and such a failure must contain a non-zero element $x_k \in S_k$ since the condition holds before k was introduced to J . Then $x_k = -\sum_{j \neq k} x_j \in N$ and $N \cap S_k$ is non-zero. Since S_k is simple, $N \cap S_k = S_k$ and thus $N \supseteq S_k$, which is a contradiction. ■

Corollary 6.2.4

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule. If M is semisimple, then M/N is semisimple.

Proof Suppose that M is semisimple. Then $M = \bigoplus_{i \in I} S_i$ where S_i are simple modules. Consider a quotient M/N and the quotient homomorphism $\psi : M \rightarrow M/N$. Clearly, $M/N = \psi(M) = \sum_{i \in I} \psi(S_i)$ and each $\psi(S_i)$ is either 0 or simple. Then $\text{soc}(M/N) = M/N$ and M/N is semisimple. ■

Proposition 6.2.5

Let R be a ring. Then R is semisimple if and only if every left R -module M is semisimple.

Proof Let R be semisimple. Let M be a free left R -module. Then M is isomorphic as R -modules to the direct sum of some copies of R . In particular, the direct sum of semisimple modules are semisimple. Hence M is semisimple. Let N be an arbitrary R -module. Since every left R -module is the quotient of a free left R -module, and quotient of semisimple R -modules are semisimple, we conclude that N is semisimple.

Conversely, if every left R -module is semisimple then R is also a left R -module and so is semisimple. ■

6.3 Completely Reducible Modules

Definition 6.3.1 (Completely Reducible Modules)

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. We say that M is completely reducible if for every R -submodule $N \leq M$, there exists an R -submodule $L \leq M$ such that $M = N \oplus L$.

Lemma 6.3.2

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule. If M is completely reducible, then N is completely reducible.

Proof Let N be a submodule of a completely reducible module M . Let P be a submodule of N . Then P has a direct complement

$$M = P \oplus K$$

Consider the quotient homomorphism $\pi : P \oplus K \cong M \rightarrow P$ defined by $\pi(p + k) = p$. The image of π is equal to P , which is a subset of N . We can restrict the map π to $\pi|_N$. Now

$$\frac{N}{\ker(\pi|_N)} \cong \text{im}(\pi|_N)$$

by the first isomorphism theorem. By proposition 3.1.3 and the fact that $\pi|_N$ is an idempotent on N , we can decompose N partially into

$$N = \text{im}(\phi) \oplus \ker(\phi) = P \oplus \ker(\phi)$$

so that we conclude. ■

Lemma 6.3.3

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. If M is completely reducible, then there exists a simple R -submodule $N \leq M$.

Proof Let M be a completely reducible R -module. Pick a non-zero element $x \in M$. Then left R -module homomorphism $\pi_x : R \rightarrow M$ defined by $\pi_x(r) = r \cdot x$ is non-zero because $\pi_x(1) = x \neq 0$. Since every ring has a maximal left ideal, $\ker(\pi_x)$ as an ideal also lies in some maximal ideal L . Notice that $Rx \cong \frac{R}{\ker(\pi_x)}$. This gives a surjective R -module homomorphism

$$\psi : \frac{R}{\ker(\pi_x)} \rightarrow \frac{R}{L}$$

defined by $\psi(r + \ker(\pi_x)) = r + L$. The module Rx is a submodule of M , and hence completely reducible by the above lemma. This means that there exists a submodule N of Rx such that $Rx = N \oplus \ker(\psi)$. The homomorphism $\psi|_N : N \rightarrow R/L$ is hence an isomorphism. Since R/L is simple, N is a simple submodule of M and so we conclude. ■

Proposition 6.3.4

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. Then M is semisimple if and only if M is completely reducible.

Proof Suppose that M is completely reducible. By the above lemma, it is clear that $\text{soc}(M)$ is non-empty. If $M = \text{soc}(M)$ we are done. So suppose not. By complete reducibility, there exists a submodule K such that $M = \text{soc}(M) \oplus K$. Since K is a submodule of M , K is completely reducible. By the above lemma, K contains a simple submodule S . But by the definition of the socle means that S should lie in soc . This is a contradiction.

Now assume that M is semisimple. Let $M = \bigoplus_{i \in I} S_i$ for simple modules S_i . Let N be a submodule of M . If $\psi : M \rightarrow M/N$ is the quotient homomorphism, then

$$M/N = \psi(M) = \sum_{i \in I} \psi(S_i)$$

with each $\psi(S_i) = \frac{S_i}{S_i \cap N}$. In particular, each $\psi(S_i)$ is either zero or simple and isomorphic to S_i . Since quotient of semisimple modules are semisimple, we have that M/N is semisimple and one can choose a subset J of I indices such that

$$M/N = \bigoplus_{i \in J} S_i$$

with $\psi(S_i) \cong S_i$ for all i .

We claim that $M = N \oplus \left(\bigoplus_{i \in J} S_i\right)$. To prove it, consider the natural R -module homomorphism

$$\varphi : N \oplus \left(\bigoplus_{i \in J} S_i\right) \rightarrow M$$

defined by $\varphi(n, (s_i)_{i \in J}) = n + \sum_{i \in J} s_i$. It is injective since for $(n, (s_i)_{i \in J}) \in \ker(\varphi)$, we have $\psi(n) + \sum_{i \in J} \psi(s_i) = 0$ together with $n \in \ker(\psi)$ to imply that

$$\sum_{i \in J} \psi(s_i) = 0$$

Using the direct sum $M/N = \bigoplus_{i \in J} S_i$, we have that each $\psi(s_i) = 0$. Since $\psi : S_i \rightarrow \psi(S_i)$ is an isomorphism, we have that $s_i = 0$. This means that we have $n + \sum_{i \in J} s_i = 0$ together with $s_i = 0$ to imply that $n = 0$. So we are done with injectivity. For surjectivity, we have for each $m \in M$, we can write a finite sum $\psi(m) = \sum_{i \in J} \psi(s_i)$ for some $s_i \in S_i$ all but finitely many non-zero. Then $m - \sum_{i \in J} s_i \in \ker(\psi) = N$ and we have that

$$\varphi\left(m - \sum_{i \in J} s_i, (s_i)_{i \in J}\right) = m$$

This show that we have an isomorphism so that M is now completely reducible. ■

Corollary 6.3.5

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule. If M is semisimple, then N is semisimple.

Proof If M is semisimple, then M is completely reducible. Submodule of completely reducible modules are completely reducible. Then by the above theorem, the submodule is semisimple. ■

Using the notion of completely reducible, we can prove that the decomposition of a semisimple module into simple modules is essentially unique.

Proposition 6.3.6

Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. If M is semisimple, then the decomposition of M into a direct sum of simple modules is unique up to reordering the direct sum.

Proof Suppose that the decomposition is given by $M = \bigoplus_{i=1}^n M_i$. We proceed by induction on n . If $n = 1$, then, M is simple and we are done.

Suppose that it is true for $n - 1$. Let $K = \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n-1} S_i$. Consider the quotient homomorphism $\psi : M \rightarrow M/K$. Clearly we have that

$$\frac{M}{K} = \psi(M) = \psi\left(\sum_{j=1}^m T_j\right) = \sum_{j=1}^m \psi(T_j)$$

Then each $\psi(T_j)$ is either 0 or simple and isomorphic to T_j so that we can reduce the indexing set so that we exclude the $j \in J$ for which $\psi(T_j) = 0$. Now we have that $M = K \oplus \left(\bigoplus_{j \in J} T_j\right)$. By proposition 2.2.2, we have that S_n and $\left(\bigoplus_{j \in J} T_j\right)$ are isomorphic. Thus $\bigoplus_{j \in J} T_j$ is actually just a single element. Without loss of generality, take $J = \{m\}$. Both $\bigoplus_{i=1}^{n-1} S_i$ and $\bigoplus_{j=1}^{m-1} T_j$ are direct complements of T_m . They are isomorphic by proposition 2.2.2. By the induction hypothesis, we conclude. ■

6.4 Maschke's Theorem

Lemma 6.4.1 (The Averaging Trick)

Let G be a finite group. Let k be a field. Let V, W be $k[G]$ -modules. Let $f : V \rightarrow W$ be a k -linear map. Then the function $f' : V \rightarrow W$ given by

$$f'(v) = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} g \cdot f(g^{-1} \cdot v)$$

is a morphism of $k[G]$ -modules.

Proof

For each $g \in G$, we know that $g \cdot - : V \rightarrow V$ is k -linear. Hence f' is k -linear. Therefore it suffices to prove that f' is a G -module homomorphism.

Let $v \in V$. Let $g_0 \in G$. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} f'(g_0 v) &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} g f(g^{-1} g_0 v) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{h \in G} g_0 h^{-1} f(hv) && (\text{Set } h = g^{-1} g_0) \\ &= g_0 \left(\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{k \in G} k f(k^{-1} v) \right) && (\text{Set } k = h^{-1}) \\ &= g_0 f(v) \end{aligned}$$

Hence we conclude. ■

Theorem 6.4.2 (Maschke's Theorem)

Let G be a finite group. Let k be a field. Then $k[G]$ is a semisimple ring if and only if $\text{char}(k)$ does not divide $|G|$.

Proof

Suppose that the character of k does not divide $|G|$. It suffices to prove that every $k[G]$ -module is semisimple by Rings and Modules. Let V be a $k[G]$ -module. We know that V must be finite dimensional. Let $U \leq V$ be a $k[G]$ -submodule. Then there exists a vector subspace $W_0 \leq V$ such that $V = U \oplus W_0$ as vector spaces.

By the averaging trick, the function $\varphi : V \rightarrow U$ defined by

$$\varphi(v) = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} g \cdot \text{proj}_U(g^{-1} \cdot v)$$

is a morphism of $k[G]$ -modules. Notice that for $u \in U$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi(u) &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} g \cdot \text{proj}_U(g^{-1} \cdot u) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} g g^{-1} \cdot u && (U \text{ is a submodule}) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} u \\ &= u \end{aligned}$$

Hence V decomposes as $k[G]$ -modules $V = U \oplus \ker(\varphi)$. Thus V is completely reducible. Hence V is a semisimple $k[G]$ -module. ■

6.5 Cosimple Modules and the Radical

Definition 6.5.1 (Cosimple)

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. We say that a submodule N of M is cosimple if $\frac{M}{N}$ is simple.

Lemma 6.5.2

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module and N a submodule of M . Then N is cosimple if and only if N is a maximal proper submodule of M .

Proof If N is cosimple then M/N has no non-trivial submodules. By the correspondence theorem this implies that there are not submodules of M containing N . Thus N is a maximal proper submodule of M . If N is a maximal proper submodule of M , then by the correspondence theorem, M/N has no submodules and so is simple. ■

Definition 6.5.3 (Radical)

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. Define the radical of M to be the intersection

$$\text{rad}(M) = \bigcap_{\substack{S \leq M \\ S \text{ is cosimple}}} S$$

of all cosimple submodules of M .

Lemma 6.5.4

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. If M is semisimple, then $\text{rad}(M) = 0$.

Proof Suppose that M is semisimple. Then $M = \bigoplus_{i \in I} S_i$ for S_i simple submodules of M . Define

$$M_i = \bigoplus_{j \in I \setminus \{i\}} S_j$$

for each $i \in I$. Since $M/M_i \cong S_i$, we have that M_i is cosimple. Then

$$\text{rad}(M) = \bigcap_{\substack{N \leq M \\ N \text{ is cosimple}}} N \subseteq \bigcap_{i \in I} M_i = 0$$

Thus $\text{rad}(M) = 0$. ■

7 Special Ideals of a Ring

7.1 Nilpotent Ideals

Definition 7.1.1 (Nilpotent Ideals) Let R be a ring. Let I be an ideal of R . We say that I is nilpotent if $I^n = 0$ for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proposition 7.1.2 Let R be a ring. Let I, J be left ideals of R . If I and J are nilpotent, then $I + J$ is nilpotent.

Proof Suppose that $I^n = 0$ and $J^m = 0$. For any $x_i \in I$ and $y_j \in J$, we have that

$$\prod_{i=1}^n (x_i + y_i) = x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n + \text{terms involving at least one } y_i$$

so that

$$(I + J)^{nm} = ((I + J)^n)^m \subseteq (I^n + J)^m = J^m = 0$$

■

Definition 7.1.3 (Nil Ideals) Let R be a ring. Let I be an ideal of R . We say that I is nil if for all $x \in I$, x is nilpotent.

Lemma 7.1.4 Let R be a ring. Let I be an ideal of R . If I is nilpotent then I is nil.

Not every nil ideal is nilpotent.

Definition 7.1.5 (Quasiregular) Let R be a ring. An element $x \in R$ is said to be quasiregular if $1 + x$ is invertible. An ideal I in R is said to be quasiregular if every $x \in I$ is quasiregular.

Lemma 7.1.6 Let R be a ring. Then the following are true.

- Let $x \in R$. If x is nilpotent, then x is quasi-regular.
- Let I be an ideal of R . If I is nil, then I is quasi-regular.

Proof If $x^n = 0$, then

$$(1 + x)(1 - x + x^2 - \cdots + (-1)^{n-1}x^{n-1}) = 1 + (-1)^{n-1}x^n = 1$$

Thus we have constructed an inverse. It follows that every nil ideal is quasiregular. ■

The converse is in general false. Consider the matrix ring $M_n(\mathbb{F})$ over a field $\mathbb{F}$. A matrix is nilpotent if and only if 0 is the only eigenvalue. A matrix is quasiregular if and only if -1 is not an eigenvalue. These are not strict implications on one another.

For the statement for ideals, consider $\mathbb{C}[[x]]$ the ring of formal power series and the subring $\mathbb{C}((x))$ of Laurent power series. The ideal

$$(x) = \{f \in \mathbb{C}((x)) \mid a_0 = 0\}$$

is quasiregular but not nil. Indeed $x \in (x)$ is not nilpotent but every $z \in (x)$ is of the form $a_1x + a_2x^2 + \cdots$ so that $1 + z = 1 + a_1x + a_2x^2 + \cdots$ is invertible.

7.2 The Annihilator of an Element

Definition 7.2.1 (Annihilators) Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $S \subseteq M$ be a subset of M . Define the left annihilator of S to be the set

$$\text{Ann}_R(S) = \{r \in R \mid rs = 0 \text{ for all } s \in S\}$$

When R is commutative left annihilators and right annihilators are the same. Moreover, notice that the left annihilator of an element $x \in M$ is precisely the kernel of the left multiplication map

$$\text{Ann}_R(x) = \ker(r \mapsto r \cdot x)$$

Lemma 7.2.2 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $S \subseteq M$ be a subset of M . Then $\text{Ann}_R(S)$ is a left ideal of R .

Proposition 7.2.3 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Let $S \subseteq M$ be a subset of M . Then $\text{Ann}_R(\langle S \rangle) \subseteq \text{Ann}_R(S)$.

Proposition 7.2.4 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then the following are true.

- M is cyclic if and only if there is an R -module isomorphism $M \cong R/\text{Ann}_R(m)$ for some $m \in M$.
- M is simple if and only if there is an R -module isomorphism $M \cong R/\text{Ann}_R(m)$ for some $m \in M$ such that $\text{Ann}_R(m)$ is a maximal left ideal of R .

7.3 The Jacobson Radical

Definition 7.3.1 (Jacobson Radical) Let R be a ring. The Jacobson radical of R is the radical of R as a left R -module. This is denoted as

$$J(R) = \text{rad}(R)$$

Theorem 7.3.2 Let R be a ring. The following are equal for R as a left R -module.

- The Jacobson radical $J(R) = \text{rad}(R)$
- The intersection

$$J_1 = \bigcap_{I \text{ is a maximal ideal of } R} I$$

of maximal ideals

- The intersection

$$J_2 = \bigcap_{M \text{ is simple}} \text{Ann}_R(M)$$

of all annihilators of simple modules

- The largest quasiregular two-sided ideal J_3 .

Proof

- $J(R) \subseteq J_2$: Let $x \in J(R)$ and M a simple R -module. For each $m \in M$ non zero, $\text{Ann}_R(m)$ is a maximal left ideal of R , in other words it is a cosimple submodule of R as a left R -module. Thus $x \in \text{Ann}_R(m)$ and $xm = 0$. It follows that $xM = 0$ and $x \in J_2$.
- $J_2 \subseteq J_1$: Let $x \in J_2$ and let I be a maximal left ideal of R . Then R/I is a simple left module so $x(R/I) = 0$. It follows that $x + I = x(1 + I) = I$. Thus $x \in I$ and $x \in J_1$.
- J_1 is a quasiregular ideal. Let $x \in J_1$. Notice that $R(1 + x) = R$ because if not, then $R(1 + x)$ is contained in a maximal ideal L . Then both $x \in L$ and $1 + x \in L$, thus $1 \in L$ and $L = R$. Thus $1 + x$ has an inverse in R , say $1 + y$. Then $(1 + y)(1 + x) = 1$ so that $y + x + yx = 0$ and

so that $y = -x - yx \in J_1$. Hence $1 + y$ also has a left inverse z . Thus

$$z = z(1 + y)(1 + x) = 1 + x$$

and that x is quasiregular.

- For any quasiregular ideal I , $I \subseteq J(R)$. Suppose the contrary. Then there exists a quasiregular ideal I not in $J(R)$. Since $J(R) \subseteq J_2 \subseteq J_1$ and J_1 is the intersection of maximal left ideals, there exists a maximal left ideal L and $x \in I$ such that $x \notin L$. Then $L + Rx = R$ and $1 = k + rx$ for some $k \in L$ and $r \in R$. But then $k = 1 - rx = 1 + (-r)x$ is invertible since $-rx \in I$. This implies that $L = R$, which is a contradiction.
- J_2 is a two sided ideal. It is clear that J_2 is an additive subgroup. Let $x \in J_2$ and $r \in R$ and M a simple R -module. We know that $xM = 0$. But also we have that $rxM \subseteq xM = 0$ and $rxM \subseteq r\{0\} = 0$. Thus J_2 is a two sided-ideal.
- Conclusion: By the first four points, $J(R) \subseteq J_2 \subseteq J_1 \subseteq J(R)$ so that they all are equal. Moreover, $J(R)$ contains every quasiregular ideal so $J(R) = J_3$.

In particular, the last equivalent characterization means that $J(R)$ is a two sided ideal so that all the above equivalent characterizations also work when considering R as a right R -module.

One can imagine the Jacobson radical to work well in commutative algebra. Indeed it is a two sided ideal so that when everything is commutative, the notion of the Jacobson radical still makes sense. We will see more of the Jacobson radical in Commutative Algebra.

Lemma 7.3.3 Let R, S be rings. Let $\varphi : R \rightarrow S$ be a ring homomorphism. If φ is surjective, then $\varphi(J(R)) \subseteq J(S)$.

Proof Since φ is surjective, for any maximal ideal m of S , we have $\varphi^{-1}(m)$ is a maximal ideal of R . Then we have

$$J(R) \subseteq \bigcap_{m \text{ maximal ideal of } S} \varphi^{-1}(m)$$

and so

$$\varphi(J(R)) \subseteq \bigcap_{m \text{ maximal ideal of } S} m = J(S)$$

Lemma 7.3.4 Let R be a ring. Then we have

$$J\left(\frac{R}{J(R)}\right) = 0$$

8 Chain Conditions

8.1 Noetherian Rings and Modules

Definition 8.1.1 (Ascending Chain Condition) Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. We say that M satisfies the ascending chain condition if for any chain of R -submodules

$$M_1 \subseteq M_2 \subseteq M_3 \subseteq \cdots$$

there is a positive integer n such that $M_i = M_n$ for all $i \geq n$.

Definition 8.1.2 (Noetherian Modules) Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. We say that M is left Noetherian if M satisfies the ascending chain condition.

The Noetherian property depends on the left / right module structure. For example,

$$R = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbb{Z} & \mathbb{Q} \\ 0 & \mathbb{Q} \end{pmatrix}$$

is right Noetherian but not left Noetherian.

Proposition 8.1.3 Let R be a ring and M an R -module. Then the following are equivalent.

- M is Noetherian
- Every R -submodule of M is finitely generated
- Every non empty collection of R -submodules of M has a maximal element

Proof

- (1) $\implies$ (2): Let M be Noetherian. Let $N \subseteq M$ be an R -submodule. If N is not finitely generated, then there exists a sequence of elements $f_1, \dots, f_n, \dots$ of N such that $f_{n+1} \notin R \cdot f_1 + \dots R \cdot f_n$. Then $(f_1) \subset (f_1, f_2) \subset \cdots \subset (f_1, \dots, f_n) \subset \cdots$ is a strictly increasing chain of R -submodules of N , and hence a strictly increasing chain of R -submodules of M . This contradicts the fact that M is Noetherian.
- (2) $\implies$ (1): Let $M_1 \subseteq M_2 \subseteq \cdots \subseteq M_n \subseteq \cdots$ be a chain of R -submodules of M . Then $N = \bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} M_i$ is an R -submodule of M . Indeed, if $a, b \in N$ then $a \in M_i$ and $b \in M_j$ for some i and j . Then $a, b \in M_{\max\{i,j\}}$ so that $a + b \in M_{\max\{i,j\}} \subseteq N$. If $a \in N$ then $a \in M_i$ for some i so that $-a \in M \subseteq N$. Finally if $a \in N$, then $a \in M_i$ for some i so that $r \cdot a \in M_i \subseteq N$ for some i .

By assumption, N is finitely generated by some elements, say $f_1, \dots, f_n$. Since $f_1, \dots, f_n \in N$, $f_i \in M_{p_i}$ for some $p_i \in \mathbb{N}$. Then $f_1, \dots, f_n \in M_{\max\{p_i\}}$. Hence $M_{\max\{p_i\}} = N$ so that the increasing chain of R -submodules terminate at finitely many steps.

- (1) $\implies$ (3): Let M be Noetherian. Let $\{M_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a non-empty collection of R -submodules. Choose $M_1 \in S$. If the set has no maximal element, then for each i we can always choose M_i so that $M_i \supset M_{i-1}$. This forms a strictly increasing chain of R -submodules of M thus contradicting the Noetherian property.
- (3) $\implies$ (1): Let $M_1 \subseteq M_2 \subseteq \cdots \subseteq M_n \subseteq \cdots$ be an increasing chain of R -submodules of M . Then they form a collection of R -submodules of M . Hence they have a maximal element say M_n . Then $M_n = M_{n+k}$ for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$ so that the chain of R -submodules of M terminate at finitely many steps.

■

Proposition 8.1.4 Let R be a ring. Let M_1, M_2, M_3 be R -modules. Let $f : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ and $g : M_2 \rightarrow M_3$ be R -module homomorphisms such that

$$0 \longrightarrow M_1 \xrightarrow{f} M_2 \xrightarrow{g} M_3 \longrightarrow 0$$

is a short exact sequence. Then M_2 is Noetherian if and only if M_1 and M_3 are Noetherian.

Proof Suppose that M_2 is Noetherian. Let $N_1 \subseteq \cdots \subseteq N_k \subseteq \cdots$ be an increasing chain of R -submodules of M_1 . Since f is injective, $f(N_1) \subseteq \cdots \subseteq f(N_k) \subseteq \cdots$ is an increasing chain of R -submodules of M_2 . Since M_2 is Noetherian, the chain terminates at finitely many steps, say $f(N_k) = f(N_{k+1}) = \cdots$. Since f is injective, this means that $N_k = N_{k+1} = \cdots$ so that the chain of R -submodules of M_1 terminates at finitely many steps. Hence M_1 is Noetherian.

Now let $T_1 \subseteq \cdots \subseteq T_k \subseteq \cdots$ be an increasing chain of R -submodules of M_3 . Since g is surjective, $g^{-1}(T_1) \subseteq \cdots \subseteq g^{-1}(T_k) \subseteq \cdots$ is an increasing chain of R -submodules of M_2 . Since M_2 is Noetherian, the chain terminates at finitely many steps, say $g^{-1}(T_k) = g^{-1}(T_{k+1}) = \cdots$. Hence $T_k = T_{k+1} = \cdots$ so that M_3 is Noetherian.

Suppose that M_1 and M_3 are Noetherian. Let $H_1 \subseteq \cdots \subseteq H_k \subseteq \cdots$ be an increasing chain of R -submodules of M_2 . Then $f^{-1}(H_1) \subseteq \cdots \subseteq f^{-1}(H_k) \subseteq \cdots$ is an increasing chain of R -submodules of M_1 . Similarly $g(H_1) \subseteq \cdots \subseteq g(H_k) \subseteq \cdots$ is an increasing chain of R -submodules of M_3 . Suppose they terminate at say $k_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ and $k_2 \in \mathbb{N}$ respectively. Then they certainly both terminate at $k = \max\{k_1, k_2\}$. I claim that $H_k = H_{k+1}$. We know that $H_k \subseteq H_{k+1}$. Let $x \in H_{k+1}$. Then $g(x) \in g(H_{k+1}) = g(H_k)$. Hence there exists $y \in H_k$ such that $g(x) = g(y)$. This means that $x - y \in \ker(g) = \text{im}(f)$. So $f(z) = x - y$ for some $z \in f^{-1}(H_{k+1}) = f^{-1}(H_k)$. This means that $f(z) \in H_k$. Then $y \in H_k$ and $f(z) \in H_k$ implies $x = y + f(z) \in H_k$. Hence $H_k = H_{k+1}$. The argument is similar for $H_{k+1} = H_{k+2}$ and so on. Hence the increasing chain terminates so that M_2 is so Noetherian. ■

Corollary 8.1.5 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then the following are true.

- If N is an R -submodule of M , then M is Noetherian if and only if N and M/N is Noetherian
- If N is an left R -module, then $M \oplus N$ is Noetherian if and only if M and N are Noetherian
- If R is Noetherian and I is a left ideal of R , then R/I is Noetherian.

Proof We just have to note for once that the following are all exact sequences of R -modules:

$$0 \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow \frac{M}{N} \longrightarrow 0$$

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow M \oplus N \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow 0$$

$$0 \longrightarrow I \longrightarrow R \longrightarrow \frac{R}{I} \longrightarrow 0$$

By the above proposition we conclude. ■

Corollary 8.1.6 Let R be a Noetherian ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then M is Noetherian if and only if M is a finitely generated R -module.

Proof Suppose that M is Noetherian. Then by 7.1.3 M is a finitely generated R -module. Now suppose that M is finitely generated. Then there exists a surjective homomorphism $\phi : R^n \rightarrow M$ for some n . Then we have an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \ker(\phi) \hookrightarrow R^n \xrightarrow{\phi} M \longrightarrow 0$$

Since R is Noetherian, R^n is Noetherian by 7.1.5. Then by 7.1.4 we have that M is Noetherian. ■

8.2 Artinian Rings and Modules

Definition 8.2.1 (Descending Chain Condition) An R -module M is said to satisfy the descending chain condition if for any $M_1, M_2, \dots$ submodules of M such that

$$M_1 \supseteq M_2 \supseteq M_3 \supseteq \dots$$

is an ascending chain, then there is a positive integer n such that $M_i = M_n$ for all $i \geq n$.

Definition 8.2.2 (Artinian Rings and Modules) Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. We say that M is left (right) Artinian if M satisfies the descending chain condition. We say that a ring R is left (right) Artinian if R is Artinian when viewed as an R -module.

An R -module or a ring is said to be Artinian if it is both left and right Artinian.

Proposition 8.2.3 Let R be a ring and M an R -module. Then M is Artinian if and only if every non-empty collection of R -submodules of M has a minimal element.

Proof Let M be Artinian. Let $\{M_i \mid i \in I\}$ be a non-empty collection of R -submodules of M . Let $M_1 \supseteq M_2 \supseteq \dots$ be a decreasing chain of R -submodules in the collection. Since M is Artinian, the chain terminates at finitely many steps, say $M^n = M^{n+k}$ for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Then M^n is clearly a minimal element.

Conversely, suppose every non-empty collection of R -submodules has a minimal element. Then in particular, any decreasing chain of R -submodules also has a minimal element, and so it terminates at finitely many steps. Hence R is Artinian. ■

Proposition 8.2.4 Let R be a ring. Let M_1, M_2, M_3 be R -modules. Let $f : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ and $g : M_2 \rightarrow M_3$ be R -module homomorphisms such that

$$0 \longrightarrow M_1 \xrightarrow{f} M_2 \xrightarrow{g} M_3 \longrightarrow 0$$

is a short exact sequence. Then M_2 is Artinian if and only if M_1 and M_3 are Artinian.

Proof Suppose that M_2 is Artinian. Let $N_1 \supseteq N_2 \supseteq \dots$ be a decreasing sequence of R -submodules of M_1 . Then $\alpha(N_1) \supseteq \alpha(N_2) \supseteq \dots$ is a decreasing sequence of R -submodules of M_2 . It terminates since M_2 is Artinian. Then $\alpha(N_m) = \alpha(N_{m+k})$ for all k . Since α is injective, this implies that $N_m = N_{m+k}$ for all k . Hence M_1 is Artinian.

Now let $T_1 \supseteq T_2 \supseteq \dots$ be a decreasing chain of R -submodules of M_3 . Since g is surjective, each $g^{-1}(T_k)$ is a well defined R -submodule of M_2 . Hence $g^{-1}(T_1) \supseteq g^{-1}(T_2) \supseteq \dots$ is a decreasing chain of R -submodules of M_2 . Hence it terminates and so the original chain terminates. Thus M_3 is Artinian.

Corollary 8.2.5 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then the following are true.

- If N is an R -submodule of M , then M is Artinian if and only if N and M/N is Artinian
- If N is an left R -module, then $M \oplus N$ is Artinian if and only if M and N are Artinian
- If R is Artinian and I is a left ideal of R , then R/I is Artinian.

Proof We just have to note for once that the following are all exact sequences of R -modules:

$$0 \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow \frac{M}{N} \longrightarrow 0$$

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow M \oplus N \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow 0$$

$$0 \longrightarrow I \longrightarrow R \longrightarrow \frac{R}{I} \longrightarrow 0$$

By the above proposition we conclude. ■

Recall that an ideal I of a ring is nilpotent if $I^n = 0$ for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proposition 8.2.6 Let R be a ring. If R is left Artinian, the Jacobson radical $J(R)$ is nilpotent.

Proof Consider the decreasing chain of R -modules $J(R) \supseteq J(R)^2 \supseteq \dots$. Since R is left Artinian, there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $J(R)^n = J(R)^{n+1}$. If $\text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n) \supseteq J(R)^n$, then we have $J(R)^{2n} \subseteq \text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n)J(R)^n = \{0\}$ and so we are done. So suppose not. Consider the quotient homomorphism $\pi : R \rightarrow R/\text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n)$. We know that

$$\pi(J(R)^n) \subseteq \pi(J(R)) \subseteq J(R/\text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n))$$

We are assuming that $\text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n) \not\supseteq J(R)^n$ and so $\pi(J(R)) \neq \{0\}$. We know that $R/\text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n)$ is left Artinian since R is left Artinian. So there exists a minimal left ideal I of $R/\text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n)$ such that $I \subseteq \pi(J(R)^n)$. Having no subideals mean that I is a simple R -module. By theorem 6.4.2, $J(R)$ is the intersection of the annihilator of all simple R -modules. Hence $\pi(J(R))I \subseteq J(R/\text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n))I = \{0\}$. Taking inverse image gives $J(R)\pi^{-1}(I) = \text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n)$. Then we have

$$J(R)^n \pi^{-1}(I) = J(R)^{2n} \pi^{-1}(I) = J(R)^n (J(R)^n \pi^{-1}(I)) \subseteq J(R)^n \text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n) = \{0\}$$

This implies that $\pi^{-1}(I) \subseteq \text{Ann}_R(J(R)^n)$ and so $I = \{0\}$, a contradiction. ■

Proposition 8.2.7 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left Artinian R -module. Then M is semisimple if and only if $\text{rad}(M) = 0$.

Proof Lemma 2.5.4 proves one direction. So suppose that $\text{rad}(M) = 0$. Then we obtain a descending chain using intersections of cosimple submodules

$$N_1 \supseteq N_1 \cap N_2 \supseteq \dots \supseteq \text{rad}(M) = 0$$

Since M is Artinian, the chain stops after finitely many steps. Then this gives us finitely many cosimple modules N_i such that

$$N_1 \cap \dots \cap N_k = 0$$

Consider the following homomorphism of R -modules $\psi : M \rightarrow \prod_{i=1}^k \frac{M}{N_i}$ defined by the individual projection homomorphism. It is injective since its kernel is $N_1 \cap \dots \cap N_k = 0$. Since there are only finitely many submodules, together with surjectivity we have that

$$M \cong \psi(M) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^k \frac{M}{N_i}$$

Thus M is semisimple. ■

Corollary 8.2.8 Let R be a ring. Then R is semisimple if and only if R is left artinian and $J(R) = 0$.

Proof Direct from the above theorem. ■

8.3 The Length of Modules

Definition 8.3.1 (Length of a Module) Let R be a ring and let M be an R -module. Define the length of M to be

$$l_R(M) = \sup\{n \in \mathbb{N} \mid 0 = M_0 \subset M_1 \subset \cdots \subset M_n = M\}$$

Example 8.3.2 Let k be a field. Let V be a vector space over k . Then $\dim_k(V) = l_k(V)$.

Proof Indeed, any chain of vector subspaces increases the dimension by at least 1 for every inclusion. ■

Lemma 8.3.3

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. Then $l_R(M) = 1$ if and only if M is simple.

Proof Trivial. ■

Proposition 8.3.4

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. If M has finite length, then M is finitely generated.

Proposition 8.3.5 Let R be a ring. Let $0 \rightarrow M' \rightarrow M \rightarrow M'' \rightarrow 0$ be a short exact sequence of R -modules. Then

$$l_R(M) = l_R(M') + l_R(M'')$$

Proposition 8.3.6 Let R be a ring. Let M, N be R -modules. Let $\varphi : M \rightarrow N$ be an R -module homomorphism. Then the following are true.

- $l_R(M) \geq l_R(N)$.
- If φ is surjective, then $l_R(M) = l_R(N)$.

8.4 Composition Series

Definition 8.4.1 (Composition Series) Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. A composition series of M is a sequence of R -submodules

$$0 = M_0 \subset M_1 \subset \cdots \subset M_k = M$$

such that $\frac{M_{i+1}}{M_i}$ is a simple R -module for $1 \leq i < k$.

Theorem 8.4.2 (Jordan-Holder Theorem) Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Suppose that M admits a composition series. Then any chain

$$0 = M_0 \subset M_1 \subset \cdots \subset M_k \subset M$$

of R -submodules of M can be extended to a composition series of M .

Proposition 8.4.3 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Suppose that M admits a composition series. Then the composition series is unique up to its permutation of its simple R -module quotients.

Proposition 8.4.4 Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. Then $l_R(M)$ is equal to the length of any composition series of M .

Proposition 8.4.5 Let R be a ring. Let M be a left R -module. Then M has a composition series if and only if M is left Noetherian and left Artinian.

Proof Suppose that M has a composition series. Then $l_R(M)$ is finite. But $l_R(M)$ is also defined to be the supremum of all ascending chains of R -submodules of M . If M is not Noetherian then $l_R(M) = \infty$ which is a contradiction. The proof for Artinian is similar.

Let M be left Artinian and left Noetherian. We construct the composition series inductively.

- When $i = 1$, choose M_1 to be any simple R -module.
- Assume that $\{0\} \subset M_1 \subset \dots \subset M_i$ has been constructed such that each M_j/M_{j-1} is a simple R -module. The set of all R -submodules of M containing M_i has a minimal element M_{i+1} since M is Artinian. Then by the correspondence theorem, M_{i+1}/M_i is simple, otherwise it contradicts the minimality of M_{i+1} .

The induction terminates eventually since M is Noetherian. ■

Theorem 8.4.6 (Akizuki–Hopkins–Levitzki Theorem) Let R be a ring. If R is Artinian, then R is Noetherian.

Proof We know that the Jacobson radical is nilpotent. Therefore we obtain a chain of R -modules

$$0 = (J(R))^n R \subseteq \dots \subseteq J(R)R \subseteq R$$

for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$. We induct on this chain. Clearly 0 is Noetherian. Now suppose that $(J(R))^k R$ is Noetherian, we want to show that $(J(R))^{k-1} R$ is Noetherian.

Now notice that $\frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$ has the structure of an $\frac{R}{J(R)}$ -module since $J(R)$ annihilates the quotient. Moreover, we know that $J(R)$ is nilpotent. Also, since R is Artinian, any quotient of R is also Artinian. In particular, we know that $R/J(R)$ is Artinian. Now $J(R/J(R)) = 0$. By 7.2.9, $R/J(R)$ is semisimple. In particular, every $R/J(R)$ -module is semisimple by 3.3.7. Hence $\frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$ is semisimple. Then $\frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$ is a direct sum of simple $R/J(R)$ -modules. By 7.2.5, R is Artinian implies that the R -submodule $(J(R))^k R$ is Artinian. Using the same corollary, $\frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$ is Artinian.

We now have that $\frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$ is Artinian and is a direct sum of simple $R/J(R)$ -modules. This implies that there are only a finite number of components of the direct sum, say $M_1, \dots, M_k$. Then

$$0 \subset M_1 \subset M_1 \oplus M_2 \subset \dots \subset \bigoplus_{i=1}^{k-1} M_i \subset \frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$$

is a composition series. By the above prp, $\frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$ is Noetherian.

We now know that $\frac{(J(R))^{k-1} R}{(J(R))^k R}$ and $(J(R))^k R$ are Noetherian, hence $(J(R))^{k-1} R$ is Noetherian, which completes the inductive step. ■

9 Structure Theorem for Finitely Generated Modules over PIDs

9.1 Torsion of a Module

Definition 9.1.1 (Torsion)

Let R be an integral domain. Let M be an R -module. Define the torsion of M to be

$$\text{Tor}_R(M) = \{x \in M \mid rx = 0 \text{ for some } r \in R\}$$

Definition 9.1.2 (Torsion Free Modules)

Let R be an integral domain. Let M be an R -module. We say that R is torsion free if $\text{Tor}_R(M) = 0$.

9.2 The Main Theorem

Theorem 9.2.1 (Invariant Factor Decomposition (Existence))

Let R be a PID. Let M be a finitely generated R -module. Then there is an R -module isomorphism

$$M \cong R^f \oplus \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \frac{R}{(a_i)}$$

where $f \in \mathbb{N}$, $a_1, \dots, a_n \in R$ are non-units and $a_i \mid a_{i+1}$ for $1 \leq i \leq n-1$. Moreover, there is an isomorphism

$$\text{Tor}(M) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \frac{R}{(a_i)}$$

Corollary 9.2.2

Let R be a PID. Let M be a finitely generated R -module. Then M is torsion free if and only if M is free.

Theorem 9.2.3 (Invariant Factor Decomposition (Uniqueness))

Let R be a PID. Let M, N be a finitely generated R -modules with invariant factor decomposition given by

$$M \cong R^f \oplus \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \frac{R}{(a_i)} \quad \text{and} \quad N \cong R^e \oplus \bigoplus_{i=1}^m \frac{R}{(b_i)}$$

Then there is an R -module isomorphism $M \cong N$ if and only if $f = e$, $n = m$ and $a_i = b_i$ for $1 \leq i \leq n = m$.

Theorem 9.2.4 (Primary Decomposition (Existence))

Let R be a PID. Let M be a finitely generated R -module. Then there is an R -module isomorphism

$$M \cong R^f \oplus \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \frac{R}{(p_i^{b_i})}$$

where $f \in \mathbb{N}$ and $p_1, \dots, p_n$ are primes in R .

Theorem 9.2.5 (Primary Decomposition (Uniqueness))

Let R be a PID. Let M, N be a finitely generated R -modules with primary decomposition given by

$$M \cong R^f \oplus \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \frac{R}{(p_i^{a_i})} \quad \text{and} \quad N \cong R^e \oplus \bigoplus_{i=1}^m \frac{R}{(q_i^{b_i})}$$

Then there is an R -module isomorphism $M \cong N$ if and only if $f = e$, $n = m$ and $\{p_1, \dots, p_n\} = \{q_1, \dots, q_m\}$.

9.3 The Rational Canonical Form

10 Graded Structures

10.1 Graded Rings

Definition 10.1.1 (Graded Rings)

Let R be a ring. We say that R is $\mathbb{Z}$ -graded if the following are true.

- The abelian group structure of R decomposes into a direct sum

$$R = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} R_k$$

where each R_k is an abelian group

- For $r_i \in R_i$ and $r_j \in R_j$, $r_i r_j \in R_{i+j}$.

We say that an element $r \in R$ is homogenous if $r \in R_k$ for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$.

If $S_k = \{0\}$ for all $k < 0$, we also say that R is $\mathbb{N}$ -graded.

Proposition 10.1.2

Let $R = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} R_k$ be a graded ring. Then the following are true.

- R_0 is a subring of R
- R_n is an R_0 -module for each $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.
- R is an R_0 -algebra.

Proof

- R_0 is an abelian group by definition. We also have that $r_0 \in R_0$ and $s_0 \in R_0$ implies $r_0 s_0 \in R_0$ which means that multiplication is closed.
- We have that for $r_0 \in R_0$ and $r_n \in R_n$, $r_0 \cdot r_n \in R_n$
- R receives the structure of an R_0 -module since each R_n is an R_0 -module. Moreover, the module structure gives rise to multiplication in R compatible with the module structure by definition.

■

Definition 10.1.3 (Associated Graded Ring)

Let R be a ring. Let I be a left ideal of R . Define the graded ring associated to R of I to be

$$\text{gr}_I(R) = \bigoplus_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{I^n}{I^{n+1}}$$

Definition 10.1.4 (Graded Commutative Rings) Let $R = \bigoplus_{k=0}^{\infty} R_k$ be a graded ring. We say that R is graded commutative if for all $r \in R_i$ and $s \in R_j$,

$$r \cdot s = (-1)^{ij} s \cdot r$$

Definition 10.1.5 (Homomorphism of Graded Rings)

Let R, S be graded rings. Let $\varphi : R \rightarrow S$ be a ring homomorphism.

- We say that φ has degree $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ if $\varphi(R_i) \subseteq S_{i+n}$ for all $i \in \mathbb{Z}$.
- We say that φ is a graded homomorphism if $\deg(\varphi) = 0$.

Definition 10.1.6 (Isomorphism of Graded Rings) Let R, S be graded rings. Let $\varphi : R \rightarrow S$ be a ring homomorphism. We say that ϕ is a graded ring isomorphism if it is a graded ring homomorphism and an isomorphism of rings.

10.2 Graded Modules

Definition 10.2.1 (Graded Modules over a Graded Ring) Let R be a graded ring. Let M be an R -module. We say that M is a graded module over R if there is a decomposition

$$M = \bigoplus_{k=0}^{\infty} M_k$$

into abelian groups and $R_i M_j \subseteq M_{i+j}$.

Proposition 10.2.2 Let $R = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} R_i$ be a graded ring. Let $M = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} M_i$ be a graded R -module. Then the following are true.

- M is an R_0 -module.
- M_n is an R_0 -module for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proposition 10.2.3 Let R be a graded ring. Let M, N be graded R -modules. Then the tensor product $M \otimes_R N$ is also a graded R -module, with grading given by

$$(M \otimes_R N)_n = \frac{\bigoplus_{i+j=n} M_i \otimes_R N_j}{\langle rm \otimes n - m \otimes rn \mid \substack{m \in M_a, n \in N_b, r \in R_c \\ \text{such that } a+b+c=n} \rangle}$$

Proposition 10.2.4 Let R, S be graded rings considered as graded $\mathbb{Z}$ -modules. Then the graded $\mathbb{Z}$ -module $R \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} S$ is also a graded ring, with multiplication defined by

$$(r_1 \otimes s_1)(r_2 \otimes s_2) = (-1)^{|s_1||r_2|} (r_1 r_2 \otimes s_1 s_2)$$

Lemma 10.2.5 Let R, S be graded rings. If R and S are graded commutative, then $R \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} S$ is also graded commutative.

Definition 10.2.6 (Twisting Graded Modules) Let $R = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} R_i$ be a graded ring. Let $M = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} M_i$ be a graded R -module. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Define the n th twisted module $M(n)$ of M to be the graded module whose d th graded piece is given by $M(n)_d = M_{d+n}$.

10.3 Homogeneity

Definition 10.3.1 (Homogenous Elements)

Let R be a graded ring. Let $M = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} M_i$ be a graded R -module. Let $m \in M$. We say that m is homogenous if $m \in M_n$ for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Definition 10.3.2 (Homogenous Submodules) Let R be a graded ring. Let M be a graded R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule of M . We say that N is homogenous if it is generated by homogenous elements of N .

Lemma 10.3.3

Let R be a graded ring. Let $M = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} M_i$ be a graded R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule of M . Then the following are equivalent.

- N is homogenous.
- Every element of N is a sum of homogeneous elements in N .
- $N = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} (N \cap M_i)$

Proof

(1) $\implies$ (2): Suppose that N is homogeneous. Let N_d be the homogeneous generators of degree d in N . Let $H = \bigcup_{d=0}^{\infty} N_d$. For any $x \in N$, write $x = \sum_{i=1}^s r_i h_i$ for $r_i \in R$ and $h_i \in H$. Now each

$r_i \in R$ can also be written as $r_i = \sum_{j=1}^{k_i} r_{ij}$ for $r_{ij} \in R_p$ for some $p \in \mathbb{N}$. Then we have

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^s \sum_{j=1}^{k_i} r_{ij} h_i$$

Now each $r_{ij} h_i$ is homogeneous of degree $\deg(r_{ij}) + \deg(h_i)$. Moreover, it lies in N since $h_i \in N$. Hence x is now a sum of homogeneous elements in N .

(2) $\implies$ (3): It is clear that $\sum_{i=0}^{\infty} (N \cap M_i) \subseteq N$. Conversely, let $x \in N$. Then by assumption $x = \sum_{i=1}^r x_i$ for homogeneous $x_i \in N$. Then $x_i \in N \cap M_{\deg(x_i)}$ and so we are done.

(3) $\implies$ (1): Clearly elements in $N \cap M_i$ are homogeneous and by assumption, they generate N . ■

Proposition 10.3.4 Let R be a graded ring. Let $M = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} M_i$ be a graded R -module. Let $N \leq M$ be an R -submodule of M . If N is homogenous, then M/N is homogenous with grading given by

$$\frac{M}{N} = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{\infty} \frac{M_i}{M_i \cap N}$$

Definition 10.3.5 (Homogeneous Ideals)

Let R be a graded ring. Let I be an ideal of R . We say that I is a homogeneous ideal if I is homogenous as an R -submodule.

Lemma 10.3.6

Let R be a graded ring. Let I, J be homogeneous ideals of R . Then the following are true.

- $I + J$ is a homogeneous ideal
- IJ is a homogeneous ideal
- $I \cap J$ is a homogeneous ideal

Proof Since every element of I, J are sums of homogeneous elements, any element of $I + J, IJ, I \cap J$ is also a sum of homogeneous elements. ■

Proposition 10.3.7 Let R be a graded ring. Let I be a homogeneous ideal of R . Then R/I is also a graded ring with decomposition given by

$$\frac{R}{I} = \bigoplus_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{R_k}{R_k \cap I}$$

Lemma 10.3.8

Let R be a graded ring. Let I be a homogeneous proper ideal of R . Then I is a prime ideal if and only if for any homogeneous $a, b \in R$, $ab \in I$ implies $a \in I$ or $b \in I$.

Definition 10.3.9 (The Homogenization of an Ideal)

Let $R = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} R_n$ be a graded ring. Let $I \subseteq R$ be an ideal of R . Define the homogenization of I to be

$$I^H = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} I \cap R_n$$

Lemma 10.3.10

Let R be a graded ring. Let $I \subseteq R$ be an ideal of R . Then the following are true.

- I^H is a homogeneous ideal of R .

- I is a homogeneous ideal if and only if $I = I^H$.
- If I is a prime ideal, then I^H is a prime ideal.

10.4 Relevant Ideals

Definition 10.4.1 (The Irrelevant Ideal)

Let $S = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} S_n$ be a graded ring. Define the irrelevant ideal of S to be

$$S_+ = S \setminus S_0$$

Definition 10.4.2 (The Relevant Part of an Ideal)

Let S be a graded ring. Let $I \subseteq S$ be a homogeneous ideal. Define the relevant part of I to be

$$I_+ = I \cap S_+$$

Lemma 10.4.3

Let S be a graded ring. Let $I \subseteq S$ be a homogeneous ideal. Then I_+ is a homogeneous ideal.

Definition 10.4.4 (Irrelevant Ideals)

Let S be a graded ring. Let $I \subseteq S$ be a homogeneous ideal. We say that I is irrelevant if $S_+ \subseteq \sqrt{I}$. Otherwise, we say that I is relevant.

10.5 Graded Algebras

Definition 10.5.1 (Graded Algebra) A graded algebra A over R is an algebra that is also a graded ring.

Proposition 10.5.2 Let R be a graded ring. Let A, B be graded R -algebras. Then the tensor product $A \otimes_R B$ is also a graded R -algebra, with grading given by

$$(A \otimes_R B)_n = \frac{\bigoplus_{i+j=n} A_i \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} B_j}{\langle rm \otimes n - m \otimes rn \mid \substack{m \in A_a, n \in B_b, r \in R_c \\ \text{such that } a+b+c=n} \rangle}$$

and multiplication given by

$$(r_1 \otimes s_1)(r_2 \otimes s_2) = (-1)^{|s_1||r_2|}(r_1 r_2 \otimes s_1 s_2)$$

10.6 Noetherian Conditions

Proposition 10.6.1

Let $R = \bigoplus_{n \in \mathbb{N}} R_n$ be a graded ring. Then R is Noetherian if and only if R_0 is Noetherian and R is finitely generated as an R_0 -module.

Proof

If R_0 is Noetherian and R is finitely generated, then by 7.1.6 we know that R is Noetherian.

Suppose now that R is Noetherian. Then $R_0 \cong R/R_+$ is a quotient of R and so is Noetherian. Since R_+ is a homogeneous ideal of R , it is finitely generated by say $x_1, \dots, x_r$ where each x_i is of degree d_i . Then we have

$$R_n = \sum_{i=1}^r x_i R_{n-d_i}$$

Indeed, the expression on the right lies in R_n . Conversely, given $x \in R_n$, there exists $f_1, \dots, f_r \in R$ such that $x = \sum_{i=1}^r x_i f_i$. If g_i is the homogeneous term of f_i of degree d_i , then we have $x =$

$\sum_{i=1}^r x_i g_i$. Hence R_n is a subset of the expression on the right. This implies that $R = R_0[x_1, \dots, x_r]$ and so R is finitely generated. ■

11 Tensor, Symmetric and Exterior Algebras

11.1 Tensor Algebra

In this section, R is a commutative ring with identity and we assume that the left and right action on every R -module is the same.

Definition 11.1.1 (k th Tensor Power) Let M be an R -module. Let $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Define the k th tensor power of M to be the tensor product

$$M^{\otimes k} = M \otimes M \cdots \otimes M$$

where the tensor product over M is taken k times. By convention, define $M^{\otimes 0}$ to be R .

Definition 11.1.2 (Tensor Algebra) Let M be an R -module. Define the tensor algebra over V to be the direct sum

$$T(M) = \bigoplus_{k=0}^{\infty} M^{\otimes k}$$

Define multiplication in $T(M)$ to be the map $M^{\otimes k} \otimes M^{\otimes l} \rightarrow V^{\otimes k+l}$, defined by

$$(m_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes m_i)(m'_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes m'_j) = m_1 \otimes m_i \otimes m'_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes m'_j$$

and then extended by linearity to all of $T(M)$.

Proposition 11.1.3 Let M be an R -module. Then $T(M)$ is a graded R -algebra with the above defined multiplication rule.

Proposition 11.1.4 (Universal Property) The tensor algebra $T(M)$ of an R -module M satisfies the following universal property. Let A be any R -algebra and $\varphi : M \rightarrow A$ an R -module homomorphism. Then there is a unique R -algebra homomorphism $\psi : T(M) \rightarrow A$ such that $\psi|_M = \varphi$.

Proposition 11.1.5 Let V be a finite dimensional vector space over $\mathbb{F}$ with basis $B = \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$. Then the k -tensors

$$v_{i_1} \otimes \cdots \otimes v_{i_k}$$

with $v_{i_1}, \dots, v_{i_k} \in B$ are a basis for $T^k(V)$ over $\mathbb{F}$. In particular, $\dim_{\mathbb{F}}(T^k(V)) = n^k$.

11.2 Exterior Algebra

Definition 11.2.1 (Exterior Algebra)

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M be an R -module. Define the exterior algebra of M to be the quotient

$$\Lambda(M) = \frac{T(M)}{\langle m \otimes m \mid m \in M \rangle}$$

Elements of the form $m_1 \otimes m_2$ are written as $m_1 \wedge m_2$ by convention.

Definition 11.2.2 (Exterior Powers) Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. Define the k th exterior power of M to be

$$\Lambda^k(M) = \frac{T^k(M)}{\langle m_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes m_k \mid m_1, \dots, m_k \in M \text{ and } m_i = m_j \text{ for some } i \neq j \rangle}$$

Proposition 11.2.3

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M be an R -module. Then $\Lambda(M)$ is a graded ring whose k th graded component is given by $\Lambda^k(M)$.

Lemma 11.2.4 Let M be an R -module. Then the following are true regarding the exterior algebra $\Lambda(M)$.

- Alternating: $m \wedge m = 0$ for all $m \in M$
- Anti-commutativity: $m_1 \wedge m_2 = -m_2 \wedge m_1$ for any $m_1, m_2 \in M$
- Graded commutativity: $m_1 \wedge m_2 = (-1)^{rs} m_2 \wedge m_1$ for any $m_1 \in \Lambda^r(M)$ and $m_2 \in \Lambda^s(M)$

Lemma 11.2.5

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M be an R -module. Then the following are true regarding the exterior algebra.

- $\Lambda^0(M) = R$
- $\Lambda^1(M) = M$
- $\Lambda(M)$ is an R -algebra.

Lemma 11.2.6

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M be a free R -module with basis $m_1, \dots, m_n$. Then the following are true.

- $\Lambda^n(M) \cong R$.
- $\Lambda^k(M) = 0$ for $k > n$.
- Suppose that M has R -basis $\{m_1, \dots, m_n\}$. Then an R -basis of $\Lambda^k(M)$ is given by

$$\{m_{i_1} \wedge \dots \wedge m_{i_k} \mid 1 \leq i_1 < \dots < i_k \leq n\}$$

- $\dim(\Lambda^k(M)) = \binom{n}{k}$.

Example 11.2.7

Let R be a commutative ring. Then there is an isomorphism of R -algebras

$$\Lambda\left(\bigoplus_{i=1}^n Rx_i\right) \cong \frac{R\langle x_1, \dots, x_n \rangle}{(x_i x_j + x_j x_i, x_i^2 \mid 1 \leq i \neq j \leq n)}$$

It is common to denote this R -algebra by $\Lambda_R[x_1, \dots, x_n]$.

Proposition 11.2.8

Let R be a commutative ring. Let M, N be R -modules. Then the following are true.

- For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have

$$\Lambda^n(M \oplus N) \cong \bigoplus_{p+q=n} \Lambda^p(M) \otimes_R \Lambda^q(N)$$

- We have $\Lambda(M \oplus N) \cong \Lambda(M) \otimes_R \Lambda(N)$.

11.3 Symmetric Algebra

Definition 11.3.1 (Symmetric Quotient) Let M be an R -module. The symmetric quotient is the ideal

$$C(M) = \langle m_1 \otimes m_2 - m_2 \otimes m_1 \mid m_1, m_2 \in M \rangle$$

of $T(M)$ generated by commutativity.

Lemma 11.3.2 The ideal $C(M)$ is a homogenous ideal.

Definition 11.3.3 (Symmetric Algebra) Let M be an R -module. Define the symmetric algebra of M to be the quotient

$$S(M) = T(M)/C(M)$$

Elements of the form $m_1 \otimes m_2$ are written as $m_1 m_2$ by convention.

Again here we are quotienting out symmetric objects so that we can treat them as the same thing.

Proposition 11.3.4 Let M be an R -module. Then the following are true regarding the symmetric algebra.

- $S(M)$ is a graded ring with homogenous components $S^k(M) = T^k(M)/C^k(M)$ called the k th symmetric power
- $S^0(M) = R$
- $S^1(M) = M$
- $S(M)$ is an R -algebra.

Theorem 11.3.5 Let M be an R -module. Let

$$I = \langle m_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes m_k - m_{\sigma(1)} \otimes \cdots \otimes m_{\sigma(k)} \mid m_1, \dots, m_k \in M, \sigma \in S_k \rangle$$

Then $S^k(M) = T^k(M)/I$.

Proposition 11.3.6 (Universal Property)

Let R be a ring. Let M be an R -module. Then the symmetric algebra $S(M)$ satisfies the following universal property. For any commutative R -algebra A and any R -module homomorphism $\varphi : M \rightarrow A$, there exists a unique R -algebra homomorphism $\psi : S(M) \rightarrow A$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M & \hookrightarrow & S(M) \\ & \searrow \varphi & \downarrow \exists! \psi \\ & & A \end{array}$$

Moreover, $S(M)$ is the unique (up to unique isomorphism) R -algebra satisfying the above.

Corollary 11.3.7

Let F be a field. Let V be a vector space over F of dimension n . Then there is a graded F -algebra isomorphism

$$S(V) \cong F[x_1, \dots, x_n]$$

given as follows. Choose a basis $e_1, \dots, e_n$ of V . Then the map is given by $e_i \mapsto x_i$.